

GRANDE SUN GABON OGOOUÉ-IVINDO REDD+ PROJECT



Project title	Grande Sun Gabon Ogooué-Ivindo REDD+ Project
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(CCB) GHG accounting period	25-year total period
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CCB Standards version	3.1
Project location	Gabon, l'Ogooué-Ivindo, Ivindo Gabon, l'Ogooué-Ivindo, Zadié Gabon, l'Ogooué-Ivindo, Mvoug
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Validation/verification body	TBC
History of CCB status	NA

Gold Level criteria	TBC
Expected verification schedule	TBC
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1 SUMMARY OF PROJECT BENEFITS

1.1 Unique Project Benefits

Outcome or impact estimated by the end of project lifetime	Section reference
1) greenhouse gas emissions Reduction The project is expected to prevent emissions totaling 74,417,068 tCO₂e by averting planned deforestation and forest degradation throughout its crediting period.	2,3
2) Community livelihood improvement and resilience The project is designed to generate positive impacts on local community livelihoods by creating sustainable income opportunities and improving access to managed natural resources. These measures are expected to reduce dependence on practices that lead to deforestation and forest degradation.	4
3) Biodiversity and ecosystem conservation The project is expected to yield significant benefits for biodiversity conservation and ecosystem service enhancement. Key outcomes include the preservation of critical habitats and increased species richness and diversity across the project zone. In addition, the project will contribute to the improvement of multiple ecosystem services, such as enhanced water quality, strengthened soil conservation, regulation of local microclimates, and sustainable provision of non-timber forest products.	5

1.2 Standardized Benefit Metrics

Category	Metric	Estimated by the end of project lifetime	Section reference
GHG emission reductions or carbon dioxide removals	<i>Net estimated removals in the project area, measured against the without-project scenario</i>	Not applicable	N/A
	<i>Net estimated reductions in the project area, measured against the without-project scenario</i>	74,417,068 tCO ₂ e	3
Forest ¹ cover	<i>For REDD² projects: Estimated number of hectares of reduced forest loss in the project area measured against the without-project scenario</i>	124,381 ha (planned)	3
	<i>For ARR³ projects: Estimated number of hectares of forest cover increased in the project area measured against the without-project scenario</i>	Not applicable	N/A
Improved land management	<i>Number of hectares of existing production forest land in which IFM⁴ practices are expected to occur as a result of project activities, measured against the without-project scenario</i>	Not applicable	N/A
	<i>Number of hectares of non-forest land in which improved land management practices are expected to occur as a result of project activities, measured against the without-project scenario</i>	Not applicable	N/A

¹ Land with woody vegetation that meets an internationally accepted definition (e.g., UNFCCC, FAO, or IPCC) of what constitutes a forest, which includes threshold parameters, such as minimum forest area, tree height and level of crown cover, and may include mature, secondary, degraded and wetland forests (VCS Program Definitions)

² Reduced emissions from deforestation and forest degradation (REDD) - Activities that reduce GHG emissions by slowing or stopping conversion of forests to non-forest land and/or reduce the degradation of forest land where forest biomass is lost (VCS Program Definitions)

³ Afforestation, reforestation and revegetation (ARR) - Activities that increase carbon stocks in woody biomass (and in some cases soils) by establishing, increasing and/or restoring vegetative cover through the planting, sowing and/or human-assisted natural regeneration of woody vegetation (VCS Program Definitions)

⁴ Improved forest management (IFM) - Activities that change forest management practices and increase carbon stock on forest lands managed for wood products such as saw timber, pulpwood, and fuelwood (VCS Program Definitions)

Training	<i>Total number of community members who are expected to have improved skills and/or knowledge resulting from training provided as part of project activities</i>	Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.	2.1.17, 4.2.1
	<i>Number of female community members who are expected to have improved skills and/or knowledge resulting from training as part of project activities</i>	Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.	2.1.17, 4.2.1
Employment	<i>Total number of people expected to be employed in project activities⁵, expressed as number of full-time employees⁶</i>	Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.	2.1.17, 4.2.1
	<i>Number of women expected to be employed as a result of project activities, expressed as number of full-time employees</i>	Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.	2.1.17, 4.2.1
Livelihoods	<i>Total number of people expected to have improved livelihoods⁷ or income generated as a result of project activities</i>	Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.	2.1.17, 4.2.1
	<i>Number of women expected to have improved livelihoods or income generated as a result of project activities</i>	Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.	2.1.17, 4.2.1
Health	<i>Total number of people for whom health services are expected to improve as a result of project activities, measured against the without-project scenario</i>	Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.	2.1.17, 4.2.1
	<i>Number of women for whom health services are expected to improve as a result of project activities, measured against the without-project scenario</i>	Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.	2.1.17, 4.2.1

⁵ Employed in project activities means people directly working on project activities in return for compensation (financial or otherwise), including employees, contracted workers, sub-contracted workers and community members that are paid to carry out project-related work.

⁶ Full time equivalency is calculated as the total number of hours worked (by full-time, part-time, temporary and/or seasonal staff) divided by the average number of hours worked in full-time jobs within the country, region or economic territory (adapted from the UN System of National Accounts (1993) paragraphs 17.14[15.102];[17.28])

⁷ Livelihoods are the capabilities, assets (including material and social resources) and activities required for a means of living (Krantz, Lasse, 2001. The Sustainable Livelihood Approach to Poverty Reduction. SIDA). Livelihood benefits may include benefits reported in the Employment metrics of this table.

Education	<i>Total number of people for whom access to, or quality of, education is expected to improve as result of project activities, measured against the without-project scenario</i>	Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.	2.1.17, 4.2.1
	<i>Number of women and girls for whom access to, or quality of, education is expected to improve as result of project activities, measured against the without-project scenario</i>	Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.	2.1.17, 4.2.1
Water	<i>Total number of people who are expected to experience increased water quality and/or improved access to drinking water as a result of project activities, measured against the without-project scenario</i>	Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.	2.1.17, 4.2.1
	<i>Number of women who are expected to experience increased water quality and/or improved access to drinking water as a result of project activities, measured against the without-project scenario</i>	Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.	2.1.17, 4.2.1
Well-being	<i>Total number of community members whose well-being⁸ is expected to improve as a result of project activities</i>	Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.	2.1.17, 4.2.1
	<i>Number of women whose well-being is expected to improve as a result of project activities</i>	Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.	2.1.17, 4.2.1
Biodiversity conservation	<i>Expected change in the number of hectares managed significantly better by the project for biodiversity conservation⁹, measured against the without-project scenario</i>	Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.	5
	<i>Expected number of globally Critically Endangered or Endangered species¹⁰ benefiting</i>	Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with	5

⁸ Well-being is people's experience of the quality of their lives. Well-being benefits may include benefits reported in other metrics of this table (e.g. Training, Employment, Livelihoods, Health, Education and Water), and may also include other benefits such as strengthened legal rights to resources, increased food security, conservation of access to areas of cultural significance, etc.

⁹ Managed for biodiversity conservation in this context means areas where specific management measures are being implemented as a part of project activities with an objective of enhancing biodiversity conservation, e.g. enhancing the status of endangered species

¹⁰ Per IUCN's Red List of Threatened Species

	<i>from reduced threats as a result of project activities¹¹, measured against the without-project scenario</i>	Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.	
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¹¹ In the absence of direct population or occupancy measures, measurement of reduced threats may be used as evidence of benefit

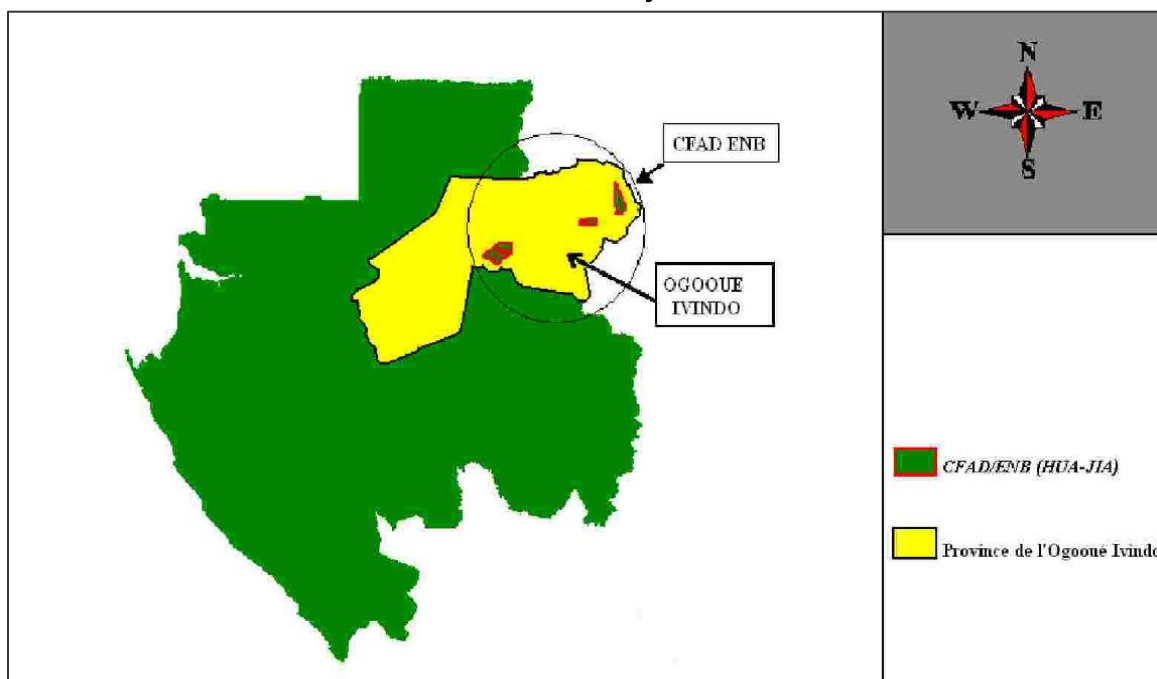
2 PROJECT DETAILS

2.1 Project Goals, Design and Long-Term Viability

2.1.1 Summary Description of the Project (VCS, 3.2, 3.6, 3.10, 3.11, 3.13, 3.14; CCB, G1.2)

The Grande Sun Gabon Ogooué-Ivindo REDD+ Project is a developed by Hainan Grande Sun Carbon Energy Technology Co.,LTD, with the objective of promoting forest conservation and the reduction of potential greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions derived from planned deforestation and forest degradation. With a focus on forest preservation, the project's primary land use remains unchanged, barring the reserved area (up to 15% of the total project area) earmarked for future expansion and development of the existing villages and provision of additional and better social services (including the respective facilities and access roads whereto) to the local communities. The project falls under the category of Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation (REDD) in the Agriculture, Forestry and Other Land Use (AFOLU) sector. The project covers an area of 146,331 hectares and is rich in forest and ecological resources. The Grande Sun Gabon Ogooué-Ivindo REDD+ Project, situated in the Mvoun, Ivindo, and Zadié departments of the Ogooué-Ivindo Province, Gabon ("the Project Area").

Locations of the Project Area



The Project Area was previously a planned logging area, yet now it is under the protection of conservation agreements. The project's primary land use remains unchanged, with a focus on forest conservation, and it also provides more and better social services (including the relevant facilities and access roads to these facilities) to the local communities.

The project follows the CCB standards, generating benefits for the climate, community, and biodiversity through activities that promote forest cover conservation and local social development. The project conserves 146,331 hectares of local forests and their biodiversity through annual monitoring of forest cover and regular monitoring of species. The local communities will be benefited through actions of social engagement, education, digital inclusion, health, access to water, employment and income generation, training and qualification, rural extension, and infrastructure.

Through the above-mentioned project activities, the forests under the Grande Sun Project will be protected from clearance, and net GHG emission reductions or removals will be achieved. At the end of the project, with the conservation of the total project area, it is estimated a total avoided emissions of 74,417,068 tons of Greenhouse Gases (GHG) (CO₂e) (2,976,682.72 tCO₂e/year), contributing to the mitigation of climate change.

The project is not located within a jurisdiction covered by a jurisdictional REDD+ program.

2.1.2 Audit History (VCS, 4.1)

To be confirmed

Audit type	Period	Program	Validation/verification body name	Number of years
Validation/verification	(DD-Month-YYYY–DD-Month-YYYY)	VCS CCB	Validation/verification body name	One year

2.1.3 Sectoral Scope and Project Type (VCS, 3.2)

Sectoral scope	14: Agriculture, forestry, and other land use
AFOLU project category ¹²	Reduced Emissions from Deforestation and Degradation (REDD)
Project activity type	Avoiding Planned Deforestation and/or Degradation (APDD)

2.1.4 Project Eligibility (VCS, 3.1, 3.6, 3.8, 3.18, 4.1; CCB Program Rules, 4.2.4, 4.6.4)

According to the VCS Methodology Requirements for REDD+, the project qualifies through its implementation of activities that effectively reduce net greenhouse gas emissions by mitigating deforestation. It is therefore eligible for inclusion under both the VCS and the CCB Program.

This project is classified as a REDD+ initiative under the activity type Avoiding Planned Deforestation and Degradation (APDD), in accordance with Appendix 1 of the VCS Standard v4.7. The following justifications support this categorization:

¹² See Appendix 1 of the VCS Standard

a) The project is designed to prevent the planned commercial deforestation of tropical forest for agricultural and timber expansion.

b) A land-use transition plan is implemented by the project, prioritizing forest conservation, sustainable community livelihoods, and carbon sequestration, thereby directly replacing the legally authorized deforestation scenario.

c) The project area is not located within a jurisdiction that is governed by an approved or operational jurisdictional REDD+ program under the VCS or JNR frameworks.

Therefore, the project meets the eligibility criteria for APDD under the VCS Standard v4.7, Appendix 1.

Eligibility Conditions of VCS Standard (version: 4.7)	Justification of Eligibility
3.1.1 Projects shall meet all applicable rules and requirements set out under the VCS Program, including this document. Projects shall be guided by the principles set out in Section 2.2.1.	The project meets all applicable rules and requirements set out under the VCS Program, as detailed in this section and in Applicability of Methodology.
3.1.2 Projects shall apply methodologies eligible under the VCS Program. Methodologies shall be applied in full, including the full application of any tools or modules referred to by a methodology, noting the exception set out in Section 3.14.1.	The applied methodology is VM0048 wherever it has material and VM0007 wherever VM0048 has no material – REDD+ Methodology Framework, v1.8. under VM0048 – Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation v1.0. Applicability conditions are detailed in section 3.1
3.1.3 Projects shall apply the latest version of the applicable methodology in all cases unless a grace period applies to the project as set out in 3.22 below. Projects shall update to the latest version of the methodology when reassessing the baseline or renewing a crediting period.	The project has already adopted the latest version of the methodology.
3.1.4 Projects and the implementation of project activities shall not lead to the violation of any applicable law, regardless of whether or not the law is enforced.	The project activity involves the conservation of native forest. These activities are eligible under the Gabon law and national REDD+ guidelines according to conditions set out in sections 2.5.
3.1.5 Where projects apply methodologies that permit the project proponent its own choice of model (see the VCS Program Definitions for the definition of model), the model shall meet the requirements set out in the VCS Methodology Requirements, and it shall be demonstrated at validation that the model is appropriate to the project circumstances (i.e., use of the model will lead to an appropriate quantification of GHG emission reductions or carbon dioxide removals).	Not applicable. Project applies the VM0048 Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation, v1.0 wherever it has material and VM0007 REDD+ Methodology Framework (REDD+MF), v1.8 wherever VM0048 has no material.

3.1.6 Where projects apply methodologies that permit the project proponent to choose a third-party default factor or standard to ascertain GHG emission data and any supporting data for establishing baseline scenarios and demonstrating additionality, such default factor or standard shall meet the requirements set out in the VCS Methodology Requirements.	Third-party default factors are applied to ascertain GHG emission data, including: Table 4.3-4.5, IPCC 2006 Appendix 1 - List of wood densities for tree species from tropical America, Africa, and Asia. Table 5.3, IPCC 2006 All the applied default factors meet the requirements set out in the VCS Methodology Requirements.
3.1.7 Where the rules and requirements under an approved GHG program conflict with the rules and requirements of the VCS Program, the rules and requirements of the VCS Program shall take precedence.	The project applies approved VCS methodology and tools. The project shall take precedence to the rules and requirements of the VCS Program over other approved GHG Program.
3.1.8 Where projects apply methodologies from approved GHG programs, they shall conform with any specified capacity limits (see the VCS Program Definitions for the definition of capacity limit) and any other relevant requirements set out with respect to the application of the methodology and/or tools referenced by the methodology under those programs.	The project applies approved VCS methodology and tools. The project shall take precedence to the rules and requirements of the VCS Program over other approved GHG Program.
3.1.9 Where Verra issues new VCS Program rules, the effective dates of these requirements are set out in Appendix 3 Document History and Effective Dates or equivalent for other program documents, and are listed in a companion Summary of Effective Dates document which corresponds with each update.	The project has adopted the latest version of VCS Program rules.
3.2.1 There are currently six AFOLU project categories eligible under the VCS Program, as defined in Appendix 1 Eligible AFOLU Project Categories below: afforestation, reforestation and revegetation (ARR), agricultural land management (ALM), improved forest management (IFM), reduced emissions from deforestation and degradation (REDD), avoided conversion of grasslands and shrublands (ACoGS), and wetland restoration and conservation (WRC). Further specification with respect to eligible activities which may be included within methodologies approved under the VCS Program can be found in the VCS Methodology Requirements.	This is an eligible AFOLU project category under the VCS Program: Reduced Emissions from Deforestation and Degradation (REDD). This project is categorized as a REDD project with the activity type of Avoiding Planned Deforestation and Degradation (APDD), as defined under Appendix 1 of the VCS Standard v4.7. The following justifications are provided: - The project aims to prevent planned commercial deforestation of tropical forest for timber development. - The project implements a land-use transition plan emphasizing forest conservation, sustainable livelihoods, and carbon sequestration, replacing the legal planned deforestation scenario. - The project does not take place in a jurisdiction that is covered by an approved or

	operational jurisdictional REDD+ program under the VCS or JNR frameworks. Therefore, the project meets the eligibility criteria for APDD under the VCS Standard v4.7, Appendix 1.
3.2.2 Where projects are located within a jurisdiction covered by a jurisdictional REDD+ program, project proponents shall follow the requirements in this document and the requirements related to nested projects set out in the Jurisdictional and Nested REDD+ Requirements.	This project is not located within a jurisdiction covered by a jurisdictional REDD+ program,
3.2.3 Where an implementation partner is acting in partnership with the project proponent, the implementation partner shall be identified in the project description. The implementation 3 Project Requirements 9 partner shall identify its roles and responsibilities with respect to the project, including but not limited to implementation, management, and monitoring of the project, over the project crediting period.	Any implementation partners are described on the Project Description, in sections 2.1.7 and 2.1.8.
3.2.4 The project proponent shall demonstrate that project activities that lead to the intended GHG benefit have been implemented during each verification period in accordance with the project design. Where no new project activities have been implemented during a verification period, project proponents shall demonstrate that previously implemented project activities continued to be implemented during the verification period (e.g., forest patrols or improved agricultural practices of community members).	Project proponents demonstrate that project activities that lead to the intended GHG benefit have been implemented during each verification period in accordance with the project design.
3.2.5 For all IFM, Avoiding Planned Deforestation (APD) (except where the agent is unknown), Restoring Wetland Ecosystems (RWE), Avoiding Planned Wetland Degradation (APWD), Avoiding Planned Conversion (APC), and ALM project types, the project proponent shall, for the duration of the project, reassess the baseline every ten years. For all Avoiding Unplanned Deforestation and Degradation (AUDD) (where the baseline is not allocated from jurisdictional level data), APD (where the agent is unknown), Avoiding Unplanned Conversion (AUC), and Avoiding Unplanned Wetland Degradation (AUWD) project types, the project proponent shall, for the duration of the project, reassess the baseline every six years. For Avoiding Unplanned Deforestation	The baseline reassessment will be conducted every six years as this is an APDD project.

projects where the baseline is allocated from jurisdictional level data, the initial project baseline validity period may be as little as one year but no more than seven years. The second and subsequent project baseline validity periods shall be no more than six years. The project proponent shall reassess the baseline at the end of each baseline validity period.	
3.2.10 Projects shall prepare a non-permanence risk report in accordance with the AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool at validation and verification. The non-permanence risk report shall be prepared using the AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Assessment Calculator and shall be included as an annex to the project description or monitoring report, as applicable, or provided as a stand-alone document.	The project has conducted a non-permanence risk analysis on validation, according to the most recent version of the VCS Program document AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool and shall perform the same report during subsequent verifications.
3.2.11 Projects shall have a minimum of a 40-year project longevity.	The project longevity is 25-years.
3.8.2 AFOLU projects shall initiate the pipeline listing process (as set out in the Registration and Issuance Process) within three years of the project start date.	The project initiated the pipeline listing process within three years of the project start date.
3.8.4 All other AFOLU projects shall complete validation within five years of the project start date.	The project's start date is 15 October 2022, and the project will complete the first validation in 2025.
3.18.1 The project proponent shall conduct a thorough assessment of the stakeholders that will be impacted by the project activities. In identifying stakeholders, the project proponent must consider the significance of user populations and how deeply affected they may be by the project activities, such that distant or intermittent user groups who will be affected in very limited ways by the project need not be defined as stakeholders. The project description shall include information on stakeholders at the start of the project, including: 1) The process(es) used to identify stakeholders likely impacted by the project and a list of such stakeholders; 2) Identification of any legal or customary tenure/access rights to territories and resources, including collective and/or conflicting rights, held by stakeholders; 3) A description of the social, economic and cultural diversity within stakeholders and the differences and interactions between the stakeholders; 4) Any significant changes in the makeup of stakeholders over time;	The project applies all the requirement on stakeholders. Please refer to section 2.3 of the PD.

5) The expected changes in well-being and other stakeholder characteristics under the baseline scenario, including impacts on resources identified as important to stakeholders; 6) The location of stakeholders, Indigenous Peoples (IPs), local communities (LCs), customary rights holders, and areas outside the project area that are predicted to be impacted by the project; 7) The location of territories and resources which stakeholders own or to which they have customary access; and 8) Any barriers to stakeholder engagement such as literacy and location or connection to electricity and how the project proponent will address such barriers.	
3.18.2 The project proponent shall conduct a stakeholder consultation before implementation of project activities. Such consultations shall be done in a manner that is inclusive, culturally appropriate, and respectful of local knowledge, and shall include: 1) A representative from each stakeholder group. 2) A discussion of the project design and implementation, including agreement and consent from stakeholder groups to participate in the consultation. 3) The risks, costs and benefits the project may bring to stakeholders. 4) All relevant laws and regulations covering workers' rights in the host country. 5) Information on impact to property rights as part of the free, prior, and informed consent (FPIC) process 6) Discussion of benefit sharing where relevant. 7) The process of VCS validation and verification and the validation/verification body's site visit.	The project has conducted the comprehensive stakeholder consultation, and it is record in the meeting minutes. Please refer to section 2.3 of the PD.
3.18.3 The project proponent shall take due account of all input received during the stakeholder consultation and through ongoing communications. The input from stakeholders may require updates to project design which shall be reported as a project description deviation. Where the project proponent does not update the project design, the project proponent shall justify why updates are not appropriate. The project proponent shall demonstrate to the validation/verification body what action it has taken in respect of	The project applies all the requirement on stakeholders' consultation and ongoing communications. Please refer to section 2.3 of the PD.

the stakeholder consultation as part of validation, and in respect of ongoing communications as part of each subsequent verification.	
3.18.4 The project proponent shall develop a grievance redress procedure to address disputes with stakeholders that may arise during project planning and implementation, including with regard to benefit sharing and all other safeguard and stakeholder engagement requirements mentioned in Sections 3.18 and 3.19 respectively. The procedure shall include processes for receiving, hearing, responding and attempting to resolve grievances within a reasonable time period, taking into account culturally appropriate conflict resolution methods. The procedure and documentation of disputes resolved through the procedure shall be made publicly available. The procedure shall have three stages: 1) The project proponent shall attempt to amicably resolve all grievances and provide a written response in a manner that is culturally appropriate. 2) Any grievances that are not resolved by amicable negotiations shall be referred to mediation by a neutral third party. 3) Any grievances that are not resolved through mediation shall be referred either to a) arbitration, to the extent allowed by the laws of the relevant jurisdiction or b) competent courts in the relevant jurisdiction, without prejudice to a party's ability to submit the grievance to a competent supranational adjudicatory body, if any.	The project applies all the requirement on grievance redress procedure. Please refer to section 2.3 of the PD.
3.18.5 The project proponent shall establish mechanisms for ongoing communication with stakeholders to allow stakeholders to raise concerns about potential negative impacts during project implementation. As part of ongoing consultation, the project proponent shall communicate at least: 1) The risks, costs and benefits the project may bring to stakeholders. 2) The benefit sharing mechanism where relevant. 3) The ongoing FPIC process. 4) All relevant laws and regulations covering workers' rights in the host country.	The project applies all the requirement on ongoing communication with stakeholders. Please refer to section 2.3 and 2.5 of the PD.
3.18.6 Prior to each validation/verification event, the project proponent shall communicate:	The project applies all the requirement on communication with stakeholders prior to each validation/verification event. Please refer to section 2.3 and 2.5 of the PD..

1) The project design and implementation, including the results of monitoring. 2) The risks, costs and benefits the project may bring to stakeholders. 3) The benefit sharing mechanism where relevant. 4) The ongoing FPIC process. 5) All relevant laws and regulations covering workers' rights in the host country. 6) The process of VCS validation and verification and the validation/verification body's site visit.	
3.18.7 The project proponent shall respect stakeholders' rights to participate in and consent to consultation as part of project design and implementation.	The project proponent respect stakeholders' rights to participate in and consent to consultation as part of project design and implementation. Please refer to section 2.3 and 2.5 of the PD..
3.18.8 The project may affect property rights only if free, prior, and informed consent is obtained from those concerned, including IPs, LCs, and customary rights holders, and a transparent agreement is reached that includes provisions for just and fair compensation. In the event there are any ongoing or unresolved conflicts over property rights, usage, or resources, the project shall undertake no activity that could exacerbate the conflict or influence the outcome of an unresolved dispute. Prior to establishing such an agreement, the project proponent shall disclose, at a minimum, the following information: 1) The nature, size, pace, reversibility, and scope of any proposed project or activity; 2) The reason(s) or purpose of the project and/or activity; 3) The duration of the project activities; 4) The locations that will be affected; 5) A preliminary assessment of the likely economic, social, cultural and environmental impact, including potential risks and fair and equitable benefit sharing in a context that respects the precautionary principle; 6) Personnel likely to be involved in the execution of the proposed project (including Indigenous Peoples, private sector staff, research institutions, government employees and others)	The project applies all the requirement and there is no ongoing or unresolved conflict. Please refer to section 2.5 of the PD.
3.18.9 All projects are subject to a 30-day public comment period. The date on which the project is listed on the project pipeline as under validation marks the beginning of the project's 30-day public comment period (see the Registration and Issuance Process for	The project meets all applicable rules and requirements. The public comment period is pending final confirmation.

more information on the VCS project pipeline).	
3.18.10 Projects shall remain on the project pipeline as under validation for the entirety of their 30-day public comment period	The project meets all applicable rules and requirements.
3.18.11 Any comments shall be submitted through the project's page on the Verra Registry. Respondents shall provide their name, organization, country, and email address. At the end of the public comment period, Verra provides all comments received to the project proponent and the validation/verification body. Verra makes a summary of all comments received public on the project's page on the Verra Registry.	The project meets all applicable rules and requirements.
3.18.12 The project proponent shall take due account of all comments received during the consultation, which means they will need to either update the project design or demonstrate the insignificance or irrelevance of the comment. They shall demonstrate to the validation/verification body what action it has taken	The project meets all applicable rules and requirements. No comments were received
3.18.13 The validation/verification body shall not finalize validation until the 30-day public comment period has ended and it has evaluated the project proponent's responses to any comments received.	The project meets all applicable rules and requirements.
3.18.14 Stakeholders may submit comments outside of the 30-day public comment period (see the Registration and Issuance Process for more information on comments received outside of the 30-day public comment period). The project proponent shall address any comments received within one year of receipt from Verra. To demonstrate they've evaluated the comments, the project proponent shall respond to the stakeholder and complete a project description deviation if applicable, or justify why no action was needed in the project description or monitoring report.	The project meets all applicable rules and requirements.
3.18.15 The validation/verification body shall assess the project proponent's responses to all comments received as part of the subsequent validation and/or verification	The project meets all applicable rules and requirements.
3.18.16 Stakeholders may submit comments at any time to request project documents that are missing from the Verra Registry. The Verra Registry will coordinate with the project proponent to provide any such documents to the project record on the Verra Registry and notify the stakeholder once the document is posted.	The project meets all applicable rules and requirements.

A1.5 Eligible REDD activities are those that reduce net GHG emissions by reducing deforestation and/or degradation of forests. Deforestation is the direct, human-induced conversion of forest land to non-forest land. Degradation is the persistent reduction of canopy cover and/or carbon stocks in a forest due to human activities such as animal grazing, fuelwood extraction, timber removal or other such activities, but which does not result in the conversion of forest to non-forest land (which would be classified as deforestation), and qualifies as forests remaining as forests, such as set out under the IPCC 2003 Good Practice Guidance. The project area shall meet an internationally accepted definition of forest, such as those based on UNFCCC host-country thresholds or FAO definitions, and shall qualify as forest for a minimum of 10 years before the project start date. The definition of forest may include mature forests, secondary forests, and degraded forests. Under the VCS Program, secondary forests are considered to be forests that have been cleared and have recovered naturally and that are at least 10 years old and meet the lower bound of the forest threshold parameters at the start of the project. Forested wetlands, such as floodplain forests, peatland forests and mangrove forests, are also eligible provided they meet the forest definition requirements mentioned above.	The GIS pictures will be provided in the formal version.
A1.6 Activities covered under the REDD project category are those that are designed to stop planned (designated and sanctioned) deforestation or unplanned (unsanctioned) deforestation and/or degradation. Avoided planned degradation is classified as IFM.	The project activity is designed to stop planned (sanctioned) deforestation as described throughout the project description.
A1.7 Activities that stop unsanctioned deforestation and/or illegal degradation (such as removal of fuelwood or timber extracted by non-concessionaires) on lands that are legally sanctioned for timber production are eligible as REDD activities. However, activities that reduce or stop logging only, followed by protection, on forest lands legally designated or sanctioned for forestry activities are included within IFM. Projects that include both avoided unplanned deforestation and/or degradation as well as stopping sanctioned logging activities, shall follow the REDD guidelines for the unplanned deforestation and/or degradation and the IFM guidelines	In case future project activity instances have areas legally sanctioned for timber production, baseline and project activity shall comprehend unsanctioned deforestation and/or illegal degradation, not the reduction of logging.

for the sanctioned logging activities, and shall follow the requirements set out in Section 3.6.2	
A1.8 Eligible REDD activities include: 1) Avoiding Planned Deforestation (APD): This category includes activities that reduce net GHG emissions by permanently stopping or reducing deforestation on forest lands that are legally authorized and documented for conversion. Planned deforestation encompasses activities where a forest system would have been cleared and replaced by a different forest system with a lower carbon stock and where the recovery of timber was not the primary objective of the initial forest clearance 2) Avoiding Unplanned Deforestation and/or Degradation (AUDD): This category includes activities that reduce net GHG emissions by stopping deforestation and/or degradation of degraded to mature forests that would have occurred in any forest configuration.	The present Project Activity is within category Avoiding Planned Deforestation and/or Degradation (APDD). This project is categorized as a REDD project with the activity type of Avoiding Planned Deforestation and Degradation (APDD), as defined under Appendix 1 of the VCS Standard v4.7. The following justifications are provided: - The project aims to prevent planned commercial deforestation of tropical forest for agricultural and timber development. - The project implements a land-use transition plan emphasizing forest conservation, sustainable livelihoods, and carbon sequestration, replacing the legal planned deforestation scenario. - The project does not take place in a jurisdiction that is covered by an approved or operational jurisdictional REDD+ program under the VCS or JNR frameworks. Therefore, the project meets the eligibility criteria for APDD under the VCS Standard v4.7, Appendix 1.

2.1.5 Transfer Project Eligibility (VCS, 3.23, Appendix 2)

Not applicable.

2.1.6 Project Design (VCS, 3.6)

Indicate if the project has been designed as:

- ☐ Single location or installation
- ☒ Multiple locations or project activity instances (but not a grouped project)
- ☐ Grouped project

2.1.6.1 Eligibility Criteria for Grouped Projects (VCS, 3.6; CCB, G1.14)

Not applicable.

2.1.7 Project Proponent (VCS, 3.7; CCB, G1.1)

Organization name	Hainan Grande Sun Carbon Energy Technology Co., LTD
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Contact person	CHENJIA HU
Title	Project Manager
Address	Room 2609, South Tower, Greenland Center, Zhengzhou, Henan PR, China
Telephone	+86 19137923530
Email	athrunhu@grandesun.cn

2.1.8 Other Entities Involved in the Project

Organization name	TBC
Role in the project	
Contact person	
Title	
Address	
Telephone	
Email	

2.1.9 Project Ownership (VCS, 3.2, 3.7, 3.10; CCB, G5.8)

The Grande Sun Project comprises five plots located in the province of Ogooué-Ivindo. Three plots, totaling 40,584 hectares, are situated in Mvounou. The remaining two plots are located in Ivindo and Zadié, covering 24,514 hectares and 81,233 hectares, respectively. The total area of the project amounts to 146,331 hectares.

The land ownership of these five plots belongs to the state, namely Gabon. However, ENB has acquired the forest concession rights (PFA - Permis Forestier Associé) for the three plots in Mvounou (Concession Numbers: 38/04, 94/04, 98/04), an industrial exploitation permit (PI - Permis Industriel) for the plot in Ivindo (Permit Number: 15/02), and an industrial exploitation permit (PI - Permis Industriel) for the plot in Zadié (Permit Number: 16/02).

ENB has further established the legality of industrial development, exploitation, and processing of forest resources within these five concession areas by signing the Provisional Convention on Development, Exploitation, and Transformation (CPAET) with the Gabonese Water and Forest Administration of Gabon.

2.1.10 Project Start Date (VCS, 3.8)

Project start date	15-October-2022
Justification	In the absence of the REDD project, this area would have undergone logging in accordance with the management plan submitted to the government for approval, thus leading to deforestation in the region. The project start date is October 15, 2022, which is the date when ENB decided to suspend the forest development plan and switch to developing the REDD project. From that date, ENB internally initiated the CCB-and-VCS application project, held a project launch meeting, and carried out a series of preparatory activities, such as mobilizing internal departments to participate and initiating external actions like contacting the local government to submit a new management plan and liaising with local communities to inform them about the project. According to the VCS Program, the start date of an Agriculture, Forestry, and Other Land Use (AFOLU) project corresponds to the moment when actions resulting in GHG emission reductions or removals are initiated. In the Grande Sun REDD+ project, this includes the decision by ENB, the owner of the forest development rights, to halt the planned timber development and conserve the area. Additional early-stage activities include specific stakeholder engagement and the implementation of social and environmental safeguards, as detailed in section 2.1.19.

2.1.11 Benefits Assessment and Project Crediting Period (VCS, 3.9; CCB, G1.9)

Crediting period	25 Years According to the VCS Standard v4.7: “3.9.3 For all AFOLU projects other than such ALM projects described in 3.9.2, the initial project crediting period shall be a minimum of 20 years up to a maximum of 100 years, which may be renewed at most four times, with a total project crediting period not to exceed 100 years.” The crediting period is 25 years in total, therefore align with the VCS Program requirements.
Start date of first or fixed crediting period	15 October 2022 – 14 October 2047
CCB benefits assessment period	15 October 2022 – 14 October 2047

Benefits to climate, communities and biodiversity will be continuously monitored and submitted to the CCB for verification throughout the project lifetime.

2.1.12 Differences in Assessment/Project Crediting Periods (CCB, G1.9)

No differences between the GHG emissions accounting, climate adaptive capacity and resilience, community, and/or biodiversity assessment and periods.

2.1.13 Project Scale and Estimated Reductions or Removals (VCS, 3.10)

☐ < 300,000 tCO₂e/year (project)

☒ ≥ 300,000 tCO₂e/year (large project)

Calendar year of crediting period	Estimated reductions or removals (tCO ₂ e)
15-October-2022 to 31-December-2022	1,295,081
01-January-2023 to 31-December-2023	2,363,524
01-January-2024 to 31-December-2024	2,363,524
01-January-2025 to 31-December-2025	2,363,524
01-January-2026 to 31-December-2026	2,363,524
01-January-2027 to 31-December-2027	2,363,524
01-January-2028 to 31-December-2028	2,363,524
01-January-2029 to 31-December-2029	2,363,524
01-January-2030 to 31-December-2030	2,363,524
01-January-2031 to 31-December-2031	2,363,524
01-January-2032 to 31-December-2032	2,363,524
01-January-2033 to 31-December-2033	2,363,524
01-January-2034 to 31-December-2034	2,363,524
01-January-2035 to 31-December-2035	2,363,524
01-January-2036 to 31-December-2036	2,363,524

01-January-2037 to 31-December-2037	2,363,524
01-January-2038 to 31-December-2038	2,363,524
01-January-2039 to 31-December-2039	2,363,524
01-January-2040 to 31-December-2040	2,363,524
01-January-2041 to 31-December-2041	2,363,524
01-January-2042 to 31-December-2042	2,363,524
01-January-2043 to 31-December-2043	2,363,524
01-January-2044 to 31-December-2044	2,363,524
01-January-2045 to 31-December-2045	2,363,524
01-January-2046 to 31-December-2046	2,363,524
01-January-2047 to 14-October-2047	1,068,442
Total estimated ERRs during the first or fixed crediting period	74,417,068
Total number of years	25 years
Average annual ERRs	2,976,682.7

2.1.14 Physical Parameters (CCB, G1.3)

The project area encompasses a total of 146,331 hectares, comprising five plots located within the Ogooué-Ivindo Province, specifically in the departments of Ivindo, Mvoun, and Zadié. These include one plot in Makokou (Ivindo Department) covering 24,514 hectares; one plot in Mékambo (Zadié Department) covering 81,233 hectares; and three plots in Ovan (Mvoun Department) with a combined area of 40,584 hectares.

Climate

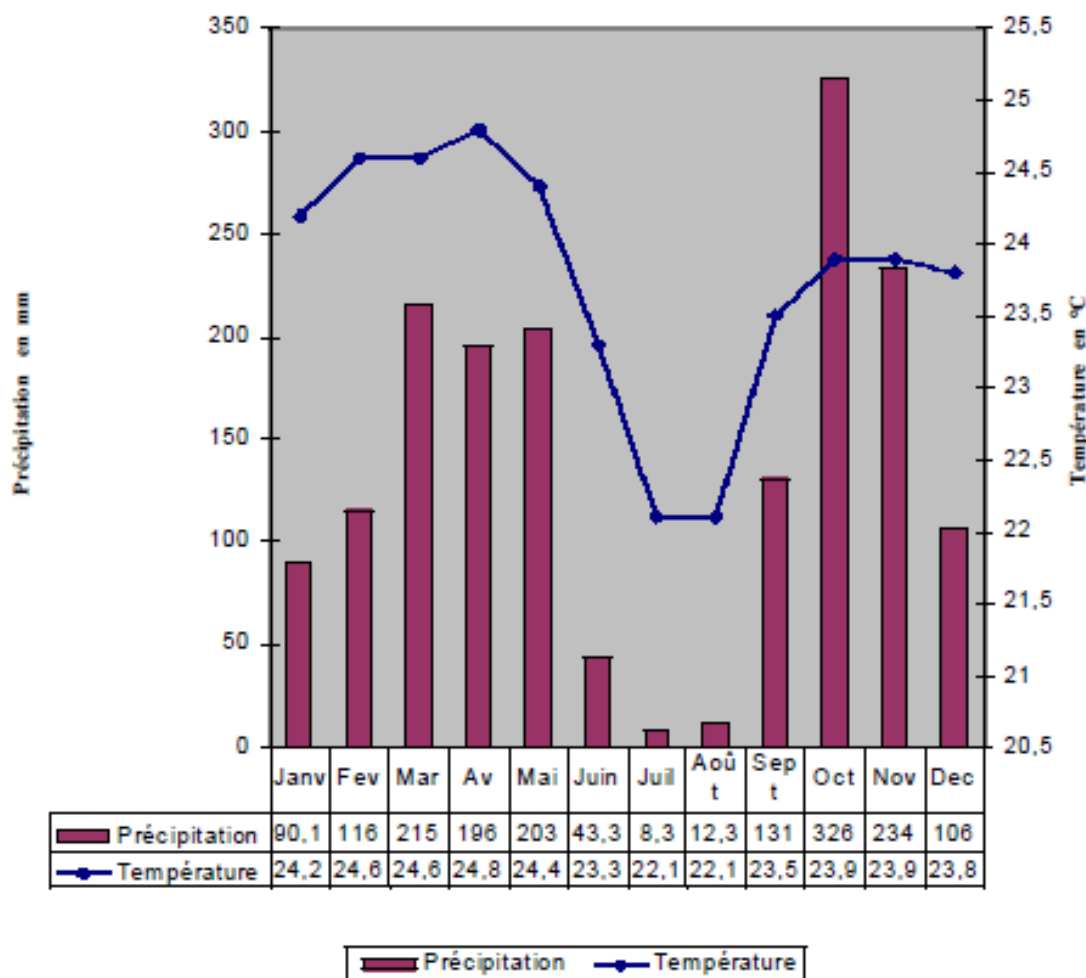
The project area, located in Ogooué-Ivindo Province (specifically Ovan, Makokou, and Mékambo), exhibits a characteristic pure equatorial climate. This climate is defined by two distinct rainy seasons (September-December and March-June) interspersed with two dry seasons of similar intensity. The wettest months are September-October (first rainy season) and March-April (second rainy season), with the eastern region (Mékambo) receiving higher precipitation than the western zone.

Critical climatic data includes an average annual rainfall of 1,680.6 mm and an average annual temperature of 23.8 °C. Extreme records show significant variability: maximum rainfall reaches 2,379 mm while minimum rainfall drops to 787.2 mm, and temperatures range from a high of 35.5 °C to a low of 13 °C. This climatic profile confirms high humidity with marked seasonal precipitation patterns and moderate thermal stability typical of equatorial regions, while also indicating considerable interannual variability in rainfall intensity.

Table X: Average Monthly Precipitation and Temperature

Mois	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
Précipitations (mm)	90,1	115,7	215,2	196	203,3	43,8	8,3	12,3	130,7	326	233,8	105,5
Températures (°C)	24,2	24,6	24,6	24,8	24,4	23,3	22,1	22,1	23,5	23,9	23,9	23,8

**Figure X: Averages of precipitation in mm and temperatures in degrees Celsius
(monthly and annual)**



Topography, Soil, and Hydrology

The project are is located in the Ogooué-Ivindo Province, with over two-thirds of its area situated in the eastern Mékambo region and the remainder in the more western Makokou and Ovan regions. This area is part of the northern geological massif of Gabon, comparable to the Chaillu massif. Its eastern portion contains significant iron deposits associated with itabirites (Mékambo, Makokou, Ovan, Mitzic, Bélinga, Minvoul). The region encompasses crystalline and crystallophyllian facies. Pegmatites are associated with these two facies groups, and additionally, basic and ultra-basic intrusions cross-cut these formations.

The soils in the project area are primarily typical ferralitic soils and deep kaolinitic clays. In the northeastern zone of Gabon (Bélinga, Batouala, Boka-Boka, Minkébé, Ovan, Mitzic, and Minvoul) at approximately 1000 meters altitude, itabirites have undergone pedological processes to form erosion-resistant summit iron crusts.

The easternmost part of the project area near Mékambo is situated on a crystalline basement. This geological unit mainly involves the extension of the Minkébé foothills within the region and extends further eastward to the neighboring Congo.

Shallow soils are distributed on surfaces rejuvenated by erosion, featuring steep slopes, low altitude, and highly fragmented terrain. These soils are generally yellow and clayey, involving kaolinite. Their very fine structure ensures good permeability, but they are also quite fragile.

Although soil conditions are not entirely uniform across the whole project area, it is important to note that in the more southern Makokou region, under the influence of the Ivindo River basin, the geological formations consist of schists, micaschists, quartzites, sedimentary-volcanic formations, and gneiss typical of eastern Gabon.

Within the project area, the hydrological regime is strongly influenced by the equatorial climate type, characterized by two maxima and two minima. The two minima are homogeneous in value and are centered on the months of July and August, respectively. The study area exhibits a typical pure equatorial climate, with the Makokou region irrigated by the Ivindo River and the Mékambo region by the Zadié River. The hydrological regimes are also influenced by other important factors, namely: topography, soil, and vegetation.

Figure X: Topography and Hydrography, Ovan

AT 1:200,000 Scale

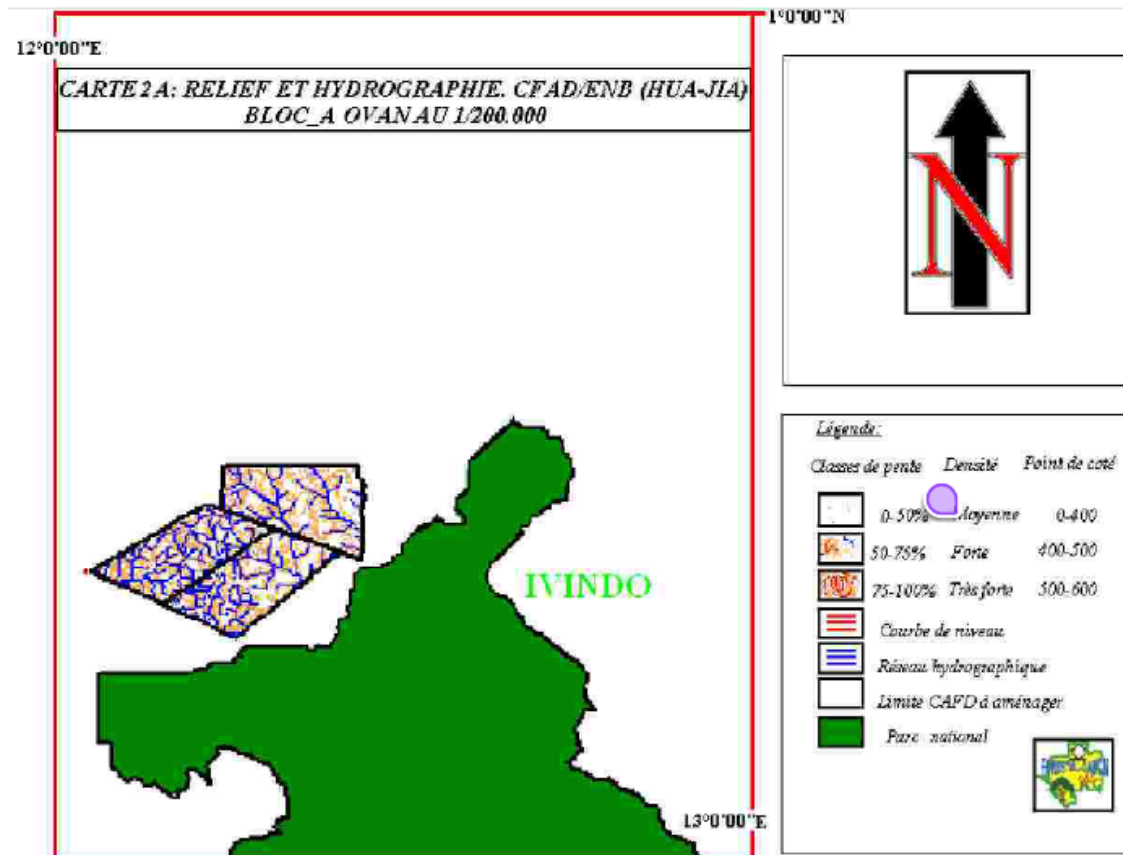


Figure X: Topography and Hydrography, Makokou

AT 1:200,000 Scale

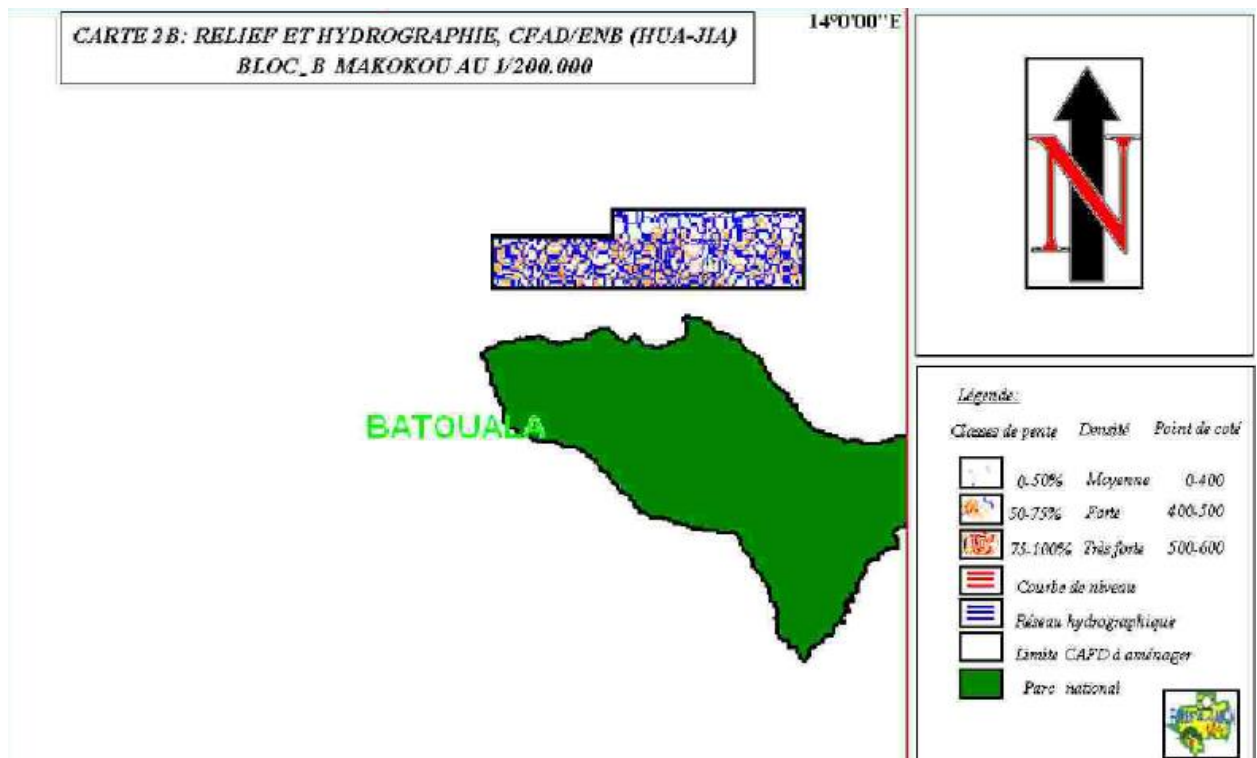
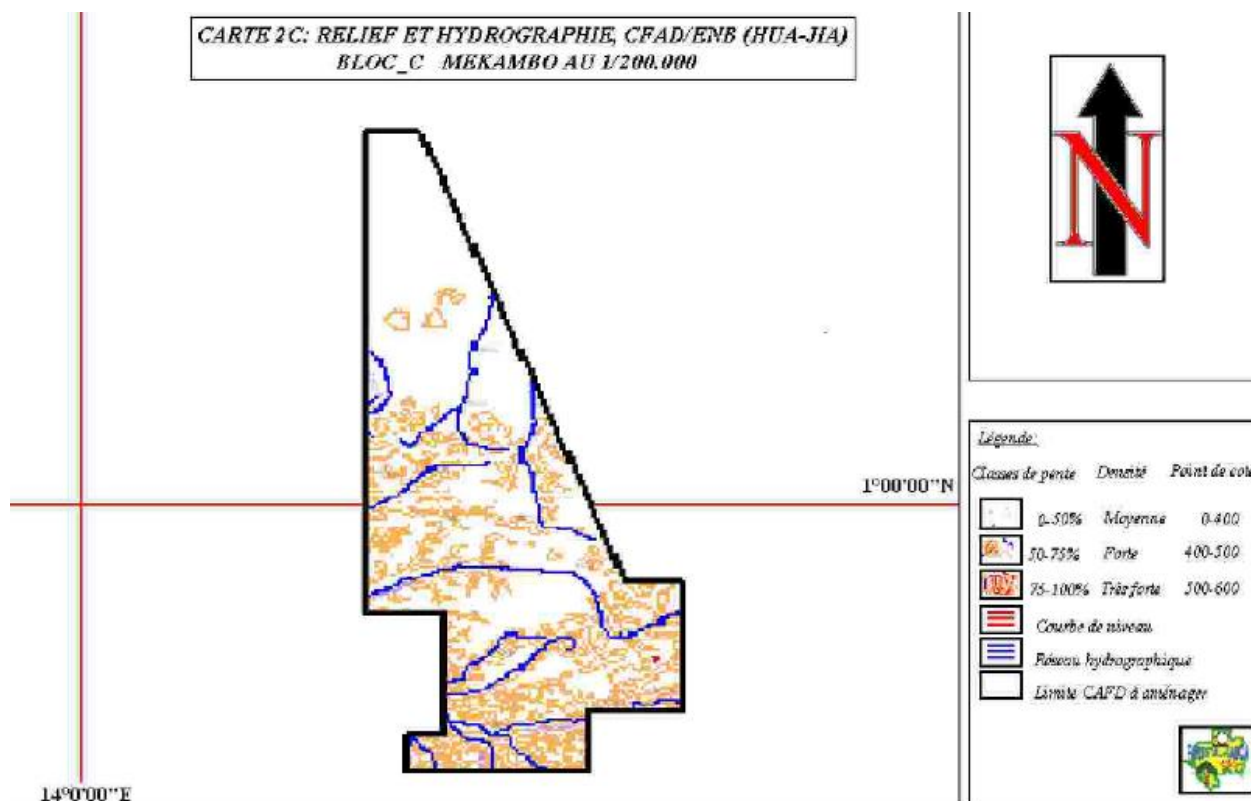


Figure X: Topography and Hydrography, Mekambo

AT 1:200,000 Scale



Vegetation

The project area exhibits distinct vegetation patterns across its two main regions. The Makokou zone features a less-exploited forest with lower rainfall, characterized by significant populations of Okoumé (*Aucoumea klaineana*) alongside species such as Ozouga (*Sacoglottis gabonensis*), Oken (*Swartzia fistuloides*), Angoa (*Erismadelphus exsul*), and Ozigo (*Dacryodes buttneri*). In contrast, the Mékambo zone represents the transition into an ancient forest belt extending from the Crystal Mountains to the Chaillu Massif. While floristically related to coastal basin forests, this area shows notably reduced densities of Okoumé and Ozigo. Its vegetation is distinctly marked by patchy distributions of Caesalpiniaceae species (particularly *Andoung* of the genus *Monoarthus*), with better representation of Mimosaceae and Papilionaceae families compared to the reduced presence of Burseraceae, Irvingiaceae, and Acaciaceae.

The woody diversity within the project area has led to a forest stratification identifying six main forest types: Cultivated land (CCS), Fallow land (JA), Swamp forest (FM), Degraded forest (DF), Marantaceae forest (FMA), and Dense forest (DF). The description of each forest stratum is as follows:

Cultivated land (CCS): Recent crop zones (e.g., cassava, banana, sugarcane) containing residual stumps of valuable tree species (Moabi, Padouk, Dibétou, *Dacryodes*, etc.).

Fallow land (JA): Old cultivated areas with colonizing species and remaining timber trees or stumps from past logging, including Azobé, Dibétou, Tali, Essia, and Okoumé.

Swamp forest (FM): Floodable area with sparse undergrowth, rich in high-value timber species such as Azobé, Moabi, Ouka, Pau Rosa, and Bossé.

Degraded forest (DF): Forest formations with low timber density but containing species such as Iroko, Andoung, Sapelli, Kosipo, Faro, Dibétou, and Okoumé.

Marantaceae forest (FMA): Often rich forest composed of grassy undergrowth (e.g., Marantaceae species) and containing timber species such as Andoung, Dossié, Doussié, Mahogany (Acajou), Limba, and Tali.

Dense forest (DF): Forest containing considerable and exploitable timber volumes, often remarkable for high-value species such as Wengé, Tali, Tiama, Tchitola, Padouk, Ozigo, Olo, Iroko, Igaganga, Afo, and Andoung.

Table X: Forest Stratification of the CFAD/ENB

Observed Stratum	Number of Plots	Area Sampled at 1% (ha)	Total Area (ha)	Percentage of Total Area
Cultivated Land	3	1.5	150	0.13%
Fallow Land	13	6.5	650	0.58%
Marantaceae Forest	89	44.5	4,450	3.97%
Swamp Forest	1,247	623.5	62,350	55.67%
Degraded Forest	368	184	18,400	16.43%
Dense Forest	520	260	26,000	23.21%
TOTAL	2,240	1,120	112,000	100%

Figure X: Forest Stratification of Main Forest Types, Ovan

At 1:200,000 Scale

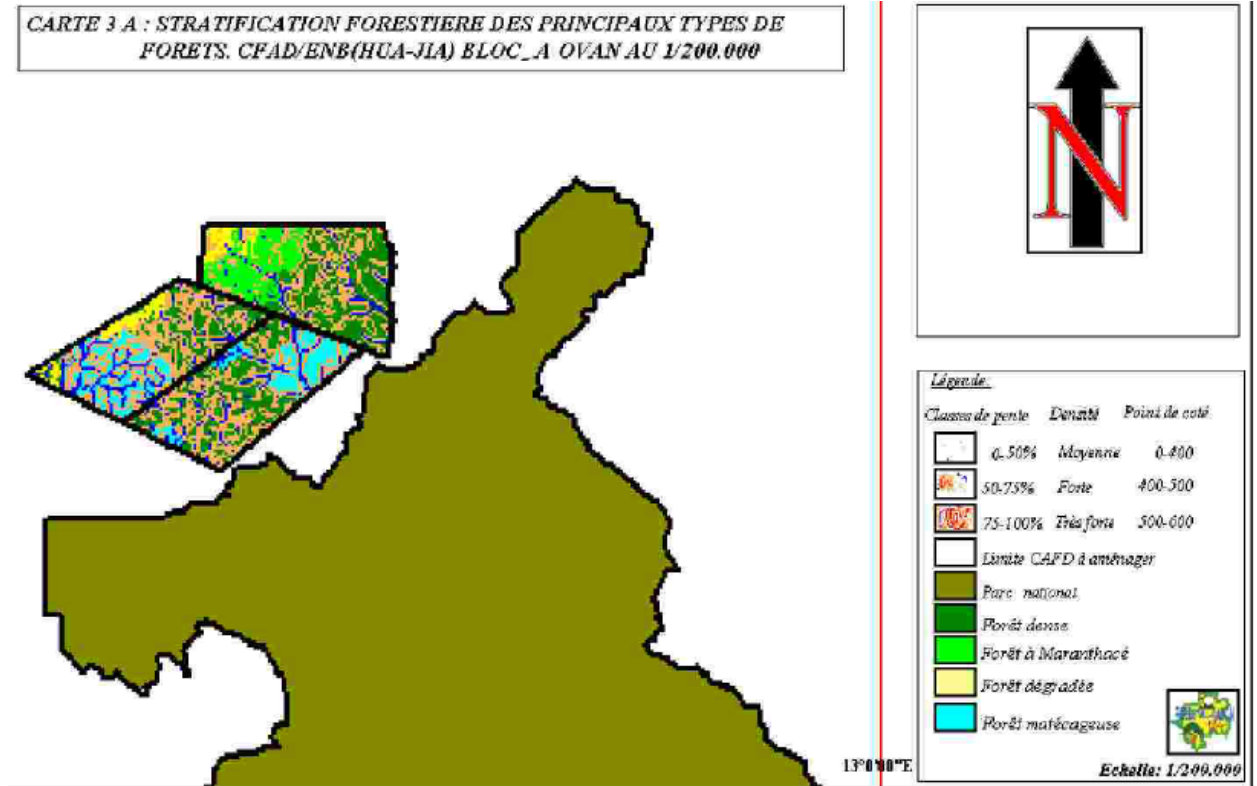


Figure X: Forest Stratification of Main Forest Types, Makokou

At 1:200,000 Scale

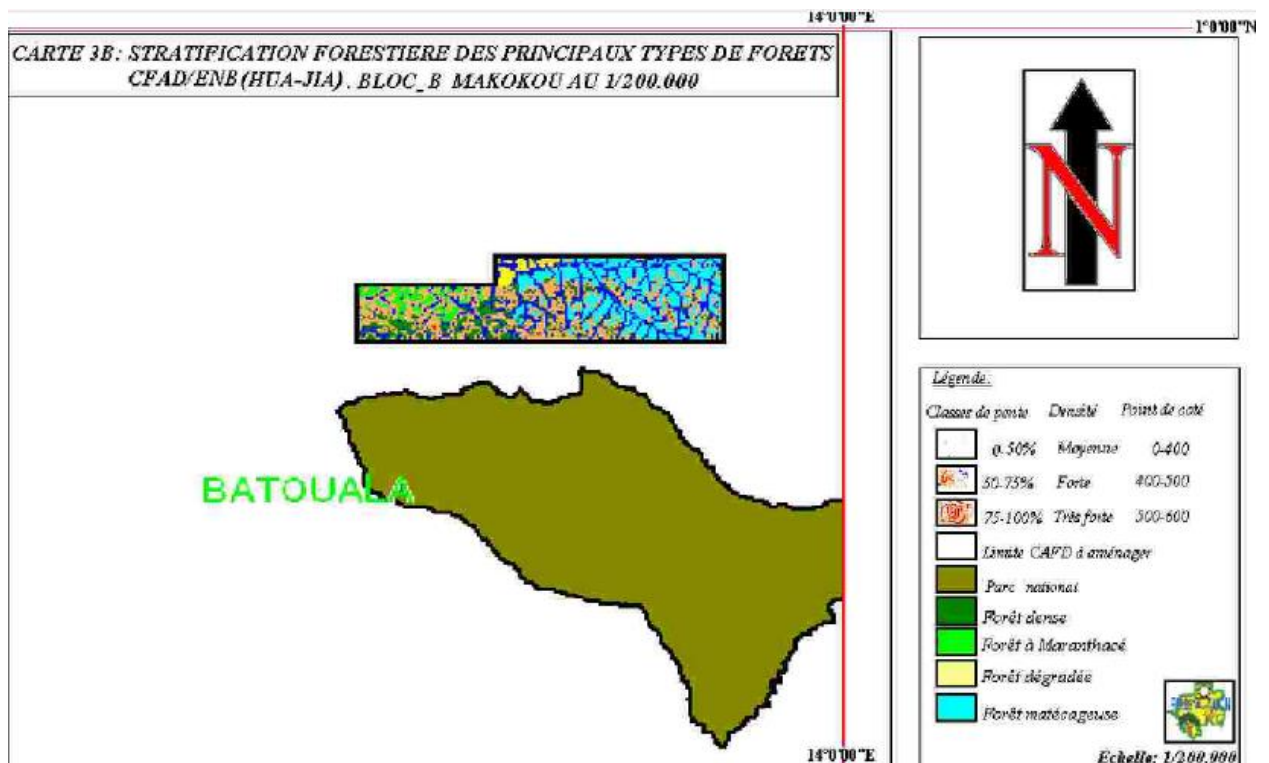
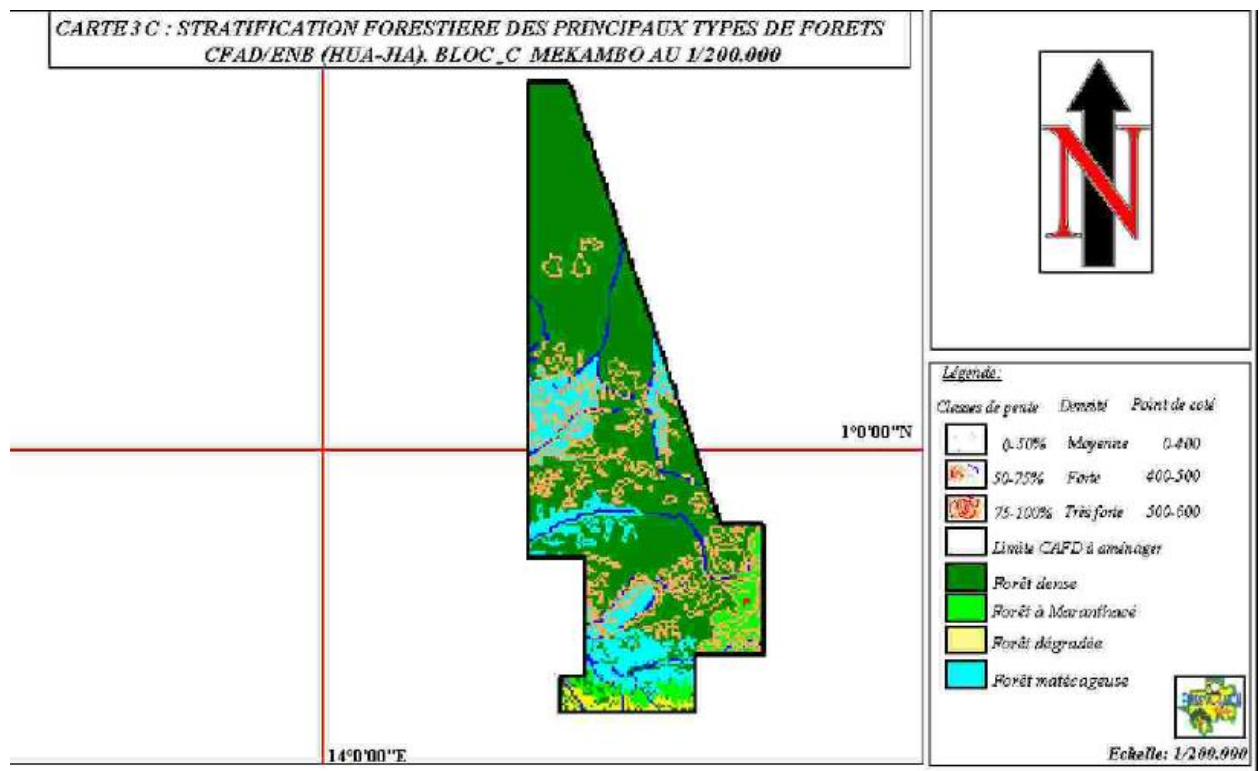


Figure X: Forest Stratification of Main Forest Types, Mekambo

At 1:200,000 Scale



2.1.15 Social Parameters (VCS, 3.18; CCB, G1.3)

The project area encompasses a total of 146,331 hectares, comprising five plots located within the Ogooué-Ivindo Province, specifically in the departments of Ivindo, Mvoun, and Zadié. These include one plot in Makokou (Ivindo Department) covering 24,514 hectares; one plot in Mékambo (Zadié Department) covering 81,233 hectares; and three plots in Ovan (Mvoun Department) with a combined area of 40,584 hectares.

Main settlements

Based on the socio-economic survey of the project area provided by Forest Company, settlements in the Ogooué-Ivindo Province are primarily distributed across the two departments of Ivindo and Zadié, with significant concentrations in the Makokou area (predominantly inhabited by the Fang ethnic group) and the Mékambo area (predominantly inhabited by the Kota ethnic group). These settlements are distributed along the boundaries of the forest concession and are predominantly riverside villages. A key characteristic of these main settlements is their multi-ethnic composition; within a single village, it is common to find a mix of ethnic groups including the Fang, Kota, Tsogho, Kouélé, Mouéta, Mahongwè, and Koya.

Relevant Historic Conditions

The Fang and Kota ethnic groups are currently the majority populations within the project area.

Information regarding population origins is interconnected and difficult to confirm; however, based on verified sources and accounts from local residents, the following origins can be stated. The Fang ethnic groups initially migrated from Cameroon to the area, with the first villages established by the Essenesele and Essensia clans. Recently, an Essanji/Essangui clan migrated into the Fang community from Equatorial Guinea via Medouneu. Their migration is the result of tribal group mobility.

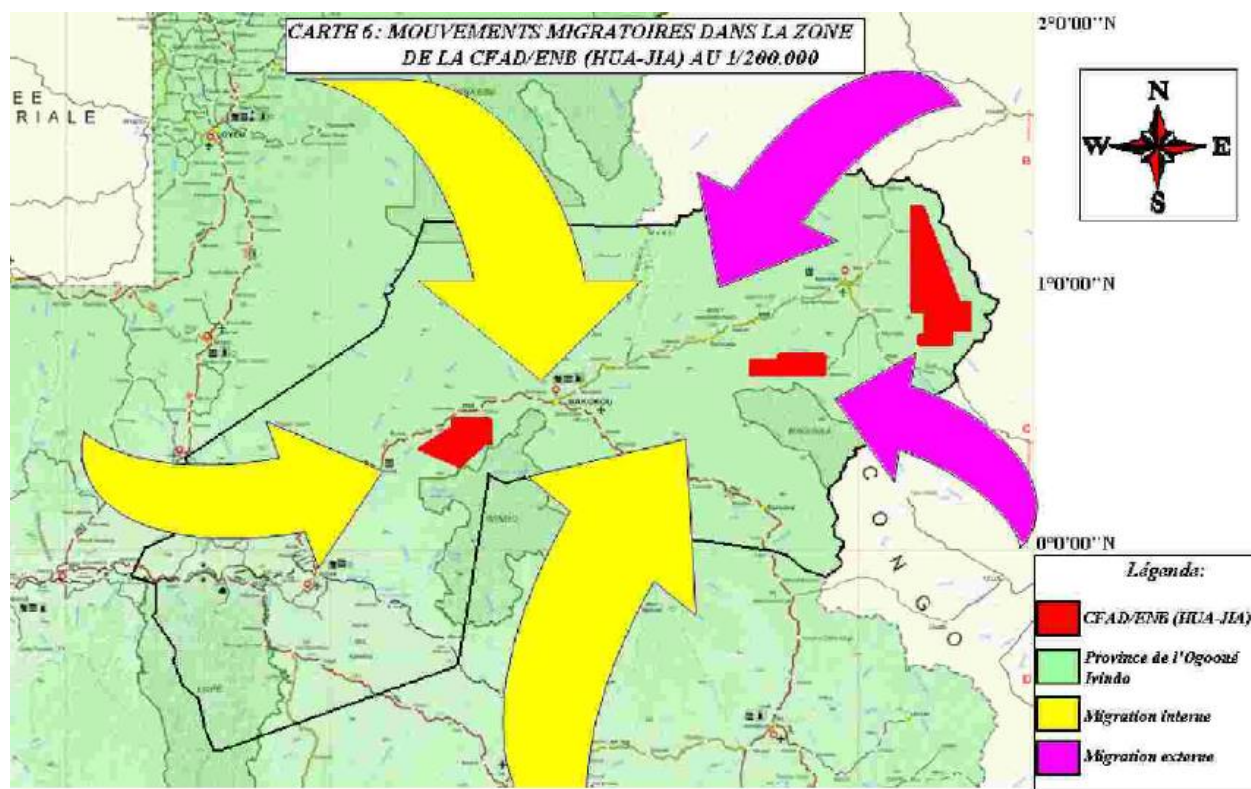
The Kota and other ethnic groups (such as Mahongwe, Bagoum, Bakota, and Sake) are distributed in Zadié Departments. Most of them returned from Congo via routes including along the Zadié River or crossing the Lowé River.

It must be noted that, due to the demographic diversity within each village, these ethnic groups do not entirely share the same origins. In fact, within a single village, one can find not only Fang and Kota people but also many other ethnic groups. The migrations are primarily related to village expansion and tribal mobility.

The following map illustrates the migration movements of the riverside communities in this region.

Figure X: Migratory Movements in the Project Area Zone

At 1:200,000 Scale



Land use, economic activities, and household income

Local people derive their income from diverse sources, yet they remain heavily dependent on the primary sale of natural resources, including agricultural produce, bushmeat and fishery products, and non-timber forest products.

- **Agricultural Sales:** Cassava and plantains/bananas are the main cash crops.
- **Bushmeat and Fishery Sales:** Hunting and fishing products are significant sources of cash income. For instance, 70% of harvested porcupines and 60-75% of harvested antelope/gazelle are sold.
- **Non-Timber Forest Product Sales:** This includes palm wine, handicrafts (furniture, fish traps), and raw materials like rattan and raffia. However, such sales primarily serve to meet basic household subsistence needs, making it difficult to assess their actual economic return.

The economic activities of the residents are primarily aimed at meeting basic subsistence needs rather than large-scale commercial profit. The level of income depends more on external infrastructure conditions, market accessibility, and environmental factors than on production capacity itself. The trade volume of all their production activities consistently remains lower than that for self-consumption. Due to poor road conditions, lack of electricity, and other infrastructure deficiencies, coupled with poor product preservation conditions, household income is highly unstable and customer availability is scarce.

Regarding the income structure:

- Women are more organized in financial management, have more diverse income sources (small-scale trade, agro-processing like cassava wine production), and save more than men. However, they must wait until the harvest season to obtain substantial earnings.
- Men, while capable of earning significant sums from the sale of bushmeat or furniture, do so only intermittently; this is not a regular occurrence.

Socio-cultural information

The majority of the population in the project area have migrated from other provinces in Gabon. Many come from nearby towns and regions such as Woleu-Ntem (including Mitzik and Minvoul) and Moyen-Ogooué (including Lambaréné and Njolé). Others have migrated from closer provinces, including Ogooué-Lolo and Haut-Ogooué.

Village mergers have also taken place locally. This process concentrated the population and also significantly boosted the young labor force in settlements. Most of the local permanent population is young people aged 10-30, with more women than men. These young people make up the main labor force of the village.

The infrastructure challenges across various regions of Gabon are highly similar. Although the vast majority of settlements and some villages are equipped with clinics, their operation faces severe difficulties, particularly due to severe shortages in medical supplies—only 1 to 2 replenishments can be conducted annually, and the distributed medicines are limited to basic drugs such as paracetamol and maleates.

At the same time, villages generally lack adequate health facilities. A few villages have health posts, but most are dilapidated, lack dedicated staff, and have no medical reserves. For example, the health post in Ntsenkele village is not a standard clinic but rather a residential house repurposed for medical use; locals refer to it as a "dispensary."

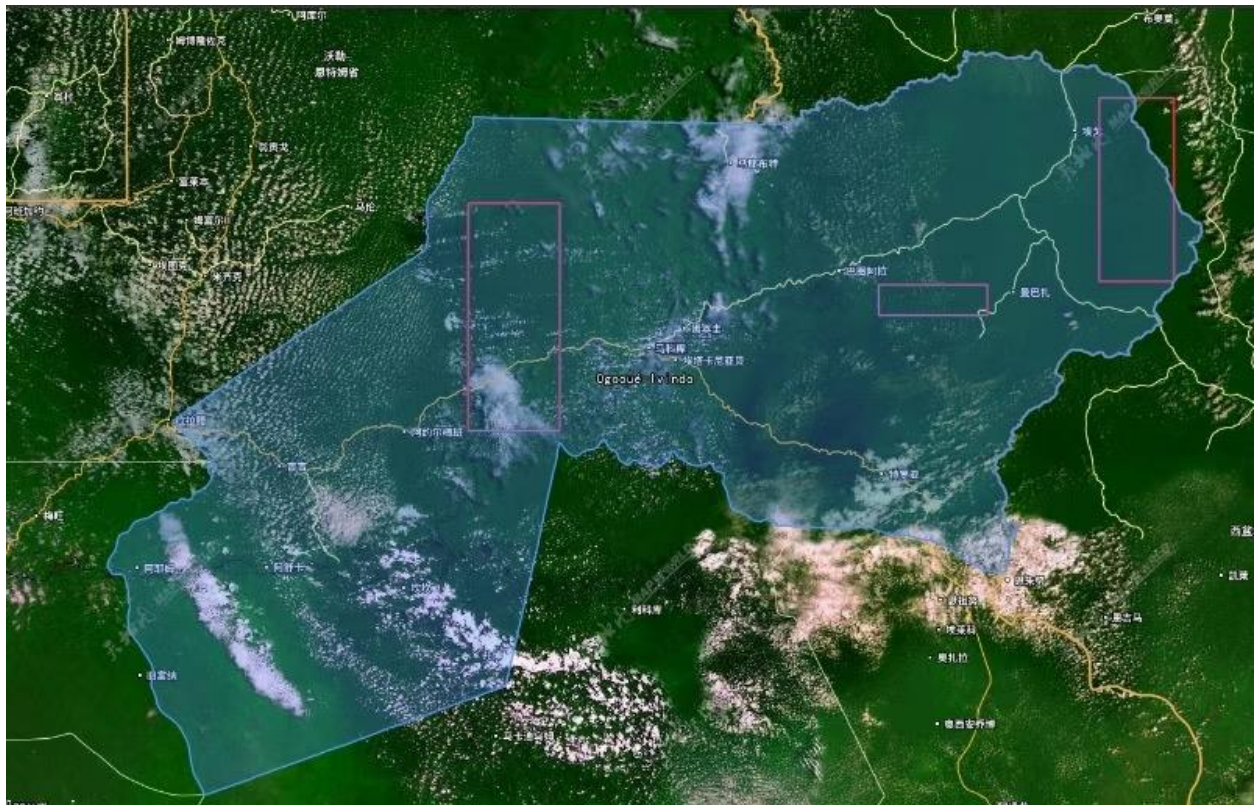
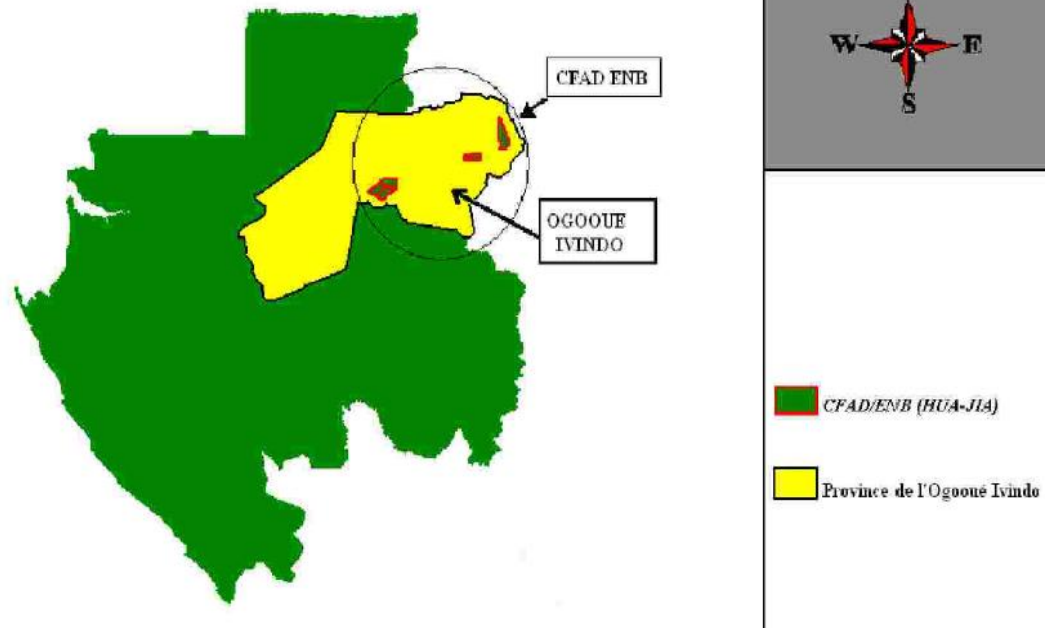
Basic education faces operational challenges similar to those of the clinics. Although almost all village settlements have established schools covering the full academic system, they often suffer from severe shortages of teaching materials, including basic supplies such as chalk, arithmetic books, and writing boards, while desks and chairs are mostly dilapidated.

Furthermore, teaching capacity is extremely weak. In some schools, only two teachers are responsible for all instructional duties, making it difficult for them to track student progress consistently and effectively—particularly for younger students in preparatory classes.

There are clear regional disparities in school infrastructure conditions: a few villages have school buildings constructed from durable materials and can ensure adequate teacher staffing, maintaining relatively normal instruction. However, the more remote the area, the more severe the situation becomes. During the rainy season, poorly constructed school buildings become unusable—water leakage not only disrupts classes but also poses safety risks to students.

2.1.16 Project Zone Map and Project Location (VCS, 3.11, 3.18; CCB, G1.4-7, G1.13, CM1.2, B1.2)

The project area encompasses a total of 146,331 hectares, comprising five plots located within the Ogooué-Ivindo Province, specifically in the departments of Ivindo, Mvoun, and Zadié. These include one plot in Makokou (Ivindo Department) covering 24,514 hectares; one plot in Mékambo (Zadié Department) covering 81,233 hectares; and three plots in Ovan (Mvoun Department) with a combined area of 40,584 hectares.



1. Plot in the Ivindo Department, at Makokou (No. 15/02)

The industrial permit No. 15/02, located in the Ivindo Department (Makokou), covers a total area of 24,514 hectares and forms an irregular polygon defined by points A through F.

- The origin point O is the geodetic datum point of BOKA B KA;
- Point A is located 18,200 meters from point O in the geographic azimuth of 172°30';
- Point B is located 2,600 meters directly south of point A;
- Point C is located 13,100 meters directly west of point B;
- Point D is located 5,400 meters directly south of point C;
- Point E is located 3,400 meters directly east of point D;
- Point F is located 8,000 meters directly north of point E;
- Point A is located 21,400 meters directly west of point F, thus closing the polygon.

2. Plot in the Zadie Department, at Mekambo (No. 16/02)

The industrial permit No. 16/02, located in the Zadie Department (Mekambo), covers a total area of 81,233 hectares and forms an irregular polygon defined by points A through L.

- The origin point O is the geodetic datum point located in MANDOMBO III Village;
- Point A is situated 10,000 meters from Point O in the geographic azimuth of 16°;
- Point B is located 4,000 meters directly north of Point A;
- Point C is situated 2,600 meters directly east of Point B;
- Point D is located 11,000 meters directly north of Point C;
- Point E is situated 6,000 meters directly west of Point D;
- Point F is located 12,000 meters directly north of Point E;
- Point G is situated 4,200 meters directly north of Point E;
- Point H is located 3,000 meters from Point G in the geographic azimuth of 199°;
- Point I is situated 4,200 meters directly east of Point H;
- Point J is located 12,000 meters directly south of Point I;
- Point K is situated 6,800 meters directly west of Point J;
- Point L is located 6,600 meters directly south of Point K;
- Point A is situated 13,300 meters directly west of Point L, thus closing the polygon.

3. Plot in the Mvoun Department, at Ovan (No. 38/04)

The forest concession rights (PFA - Permis Forestier Associé) No. 38/04, located in the Mvoun Department (Ovan), covers a total area of 10,884 hectares and forms an irregular polygon defined by points A through D.

- The starting point O is the geodetic datum point located in Ntsenkele (on the Owando-Makokou Highway);
- Point A is situated 10,600 meters from Point O in the geographic azimuth of 120°;
- Point B is situated 8,000 meters from Point A in the geographic azimuth of 299°;
- Point C is situated 13,400 meters from Point B in the geographic azimuth of 139°;
- Point D is situated 8,000 meters from Point C in the geographic azimuth of 69°;
- Point A is situated 13,600 meters from Point D in the geographic azimuth of 319°, thus closing the polygon.

4. Plot in the Mvoun Department, at Ovan (No. 94/04)

The forest concession rights (PFA - Permis Forestier Associé) No. 94/04, located in the Mvounge Department (Ovan), covers a total area of 15,000 hectares and forms an irregular polygon defined by points A through D.

- The origin point O is the geodetic benchmark of NTSENKELE (Owando-Makokou road);
- Point A is located 3,400 m from O with a geographic orientation of 190°;
- Point B is located 7,200 m from A with an orientation of 190°;
- Point C on the Louli is located 12,000 m from B with a geographic orientation of 249°;
- Point D on the Louli is located 11,600 m from C with a geographic orientation of 356°;
- The DC boundary on the Louli is materialized by the Louli;
- Point A is located 13,200 m to the geographic West of D and closes the polygon.
- Point A is situated 13,600 meters from Point D in the geographic azimuth of 319°, thus closing the polygon.

5. Plot in the Mvounge Department, at Ovan (No. 94/04)

The forest concession rights (PFA - Permis Forestier Associé) No. 94/04, located in the Mvounge Department (Ovan), covers a total area of 15,000 hectares and forms an irregular polygon defined by points A through D.

- The origin point O is the geodetic benchmark of NTSENKELE (Owando-Makokou road);
- Point A is located 10,600 m from O with a geographic orientation of 190°;
- Point B is located 8,000 m from A with a geographic orientation of 139°;
- Point C is located 13,400 m from B with a geographic orientation of 240°;
- Point D is located 8,000 m from C with a geographic orientation of 319° and closes the polygon.

2.1.17 Project Activities and Theory of Change (VCS, 3.6; CCB, G1.8)

The Grande Sun Project encompasses a total area of 1,463,311 hectares, of which up to 15% (approximately 219,497 hectares) is designated as a community-use buffer zone to mitigate potential leakage risks. Prior to the project's initiation, SOCIETE EXPORT NEGOCE DU BOIS (E.N.B) Limited had secured logging rights for this forest area under a Provisional Convention on Development, Exploitation, and Transformation (CPAET) signed with the Gabonese Water and Forest Administration. Originally intended for development, the area is now transitioning into a zone dedicated to forest conservation and protection.

The Grande Sun Project focuses on implementing conservation strategies to prevent planned deforestation across the project zone. By avoiding tree removal or clearing, the project ensures the long-term preservation of forest cover. The project prohibits the conversion of forested areas to agricultural or industrial use. This ensures the region remains a stable habitat for native species, supports sustainable development, and enhances community well-being.

The project implements a variety of forest conservation measures, including the establishment and management of surveillance teams to monitor suspicious activities and prevent unauthorized intrusion into the project zone. Additional mitigation actions to avoid planned deforestation will involve strengthened monitoring efforts, mapping of local deforestation

drivers, partnerships with academic and research institutions, and the provision of benefits to surrounding communities. These initiatives aim to reduce deforestation by creating alternative sources of income, improving education, and offering vocational training. Through the implementation of these activities, Grande Sun works in partnership with local communities to protect their forest areas from deforestation.

By aligning with the UNSDGs, the project delivers focused and directed contributions to sustainable development. The 17 goals provide a comprehensive mechanism for prioritizing key resources in the project area—including biodiversity, natural capital, financial and human resources, social assets, and carbon stocks—to systematically improve local socio-environmental conditions.



Reducing emissions from deforestation and forest degradation

The impact of these measures is anticipated to result in net GHG emission reductions through the avoidance of planned deforestation and the consequent maintenance and augmentation of carbon storage.

Activity description	Expected climate, community, and/or biodiversity			Relevance to project's objectives
	Outputs (short term)	Outcomes (medium term)	Impacts (long term)	
Collaborate with local people on forest conservation and	Formulation and implementation of forest conservation plans	The REDD+ project has been successfully validated and verified,	Contributing to the reduction of greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions, supporting the preservation of	Mitigating global climate change and conserving forest ecosystems. The execution of formal agreements with landowners directly supports

sustainable stewardship		leading to the issuance of verified carbon units (VCUs). Furthermore, the project contributes to the advancement of local community development initiatives.	forest ecosystems, and fostering sustainable community development.	these goals by contributing to emission reductions and maintaining forest cover.
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Community health and well-being

Through the introduction of health education initiatives and the setup of local medical facilities, the project seeks to elevate public health conditions, improve overall quality of life, and build community capacity to respond to health and climate risks. These efforts are consistent with the project's broader aims of advancing sustainable development and supporting human welfare within a forest conservation framework.

Activity description	Expected climate, community, and/or biodiversity			Relevance to project's objectives
	Outputs (short term)	Outcomes (medium term)	Impacts (long term)	
Health Education Programs - Implementing health education programs focused on topics such as nutrition, sanitation, and disease prevention.	Increased awareness and knowledge of health issues and improved hygiene practices within the community through the delivery of educational materials and workshops.	Adoption of healthier behaviours and practices among community members, leading to improved overall health and well-being.	Enhanced community resilience to health-related challenges and improved quality of life.	Contribute to the overall objective of sustainable development and highlights the importance of human well-being in the context of forest conservation.
Establishment of local Clinics - Establishing a clinic in the	Increased access to primary healthcare services within the community	Improved health and timely treatment of diseases,	Enhanced community health and well-being through regular	Address the immediate healthcare needs of the community, contributing to

community to provide primary healthcare services.	through the establishment and operationalization of the clinic.	leading to reduced morbidity rates.	healthcare services, resulting in an improved quality of life for community members.	sustainable development goals and promoting the well-being of local communities.
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Community Livelihood

The project aims to generate short-term outputs—including higher local employment and improved infrastructure—by engaging community members, supporting small businesses, and developing infrastructure. These contribute to medium-term outcomes such as increased economic well-being, preserved cultural heritage, and enhanced living standards. Long-term impacts comprise strengthened livelihoods, sustainable economic growth, and greater community resilience.

Activity description	Expected climate, community, and/or biodiversity			Relevance to project's objectives
	Outputs (short term)	Outcomes (medium term)	Impacts (long term)	
Employment of Local Community - Providing job opportunities to members of the local community within the project.	Increased employment and income generation for local community members through project-related positions.	Enhanced economic well-being and reduced unemployment rates within the community.	Improved livelihoods, reduced poverty, and increased economic sustainability for the community.	Directly contribute to the objective of promoting inclusive and sustainable economic growth.
Micro- and Small Business Support - Providing support and resources to develop micro- and small businesses in agricultural activities,	Increased establishment and operation of micro- and small businesses in agriculture, livestock, and fish farming.	Improved income generation, employment opportunities, and food security within the community.	Enhanced economic stability, reduced poverty, and increased food self-sufficiency for the community.	Contribute to the objective of promoting sustainable and inclusive economic growth while addressing food security needs.

livestock rearing, and fish farming.				
Infrastructure Development - Constructing infrastructure such as roads and houses in the project area.	Improved accessibility through the construction of roads and enhanced housing conditions through the provision of new houses or renovations.	Increased connectivity, improved transportation, and better living conditions within the community.	Boosted economic activities, increased social cohesion, and improved quality of life for community members.	Facilitate economic growth, improves living standards, and supports the overall development of the community.

Education and development

The project will construct schools, establishes a library, offers scholarships, alongside conducting training workshops. These efforts produce short-term outputs including new infrastructure, awarded scholarships, and workshop completion. These in turn lead to medium-term outcomes such as expanded educational access, stronger digital literacy, and improved knowledge and skills. Long-term impacts feature enhanced educational opportunities, elevated human capital, and sustainable community development.

Activity description	Expected climate, community, and/or biodiversity			Relevance to project's objectives
	Outputs (short term)	Outcomes (medium term)	Impacts (long term)	
School and Library Construction and Scholarship Provision	Construction of a school and library infrastructure, awarding scholarships to eligible students to support their educational pursuits.	Increased access to quality education and improved literacy rates within the community.	Enhanced educational opportunities, increased human capital, and improved socio-economic development within the community.	Directly aligns with the objective of promoting inclusive and equitable quality education for all.
Providing training and workshops on various topics	Participation in training sessions and workshops on sustainable	Increased knowledge and skills in sustainable	Improved environmental stewardship, enhanced	Promote capacity building, knowledge transfer, and

such as sustainable development, fireproofing, firefighting, and Community-Based Conservation (CCB)	development, fireproofing, firefighting, and CCB practices.	practices, fire safety, and community-based conservation.	disaster preparedness, and increased community engagement in conservation efforts.	community empowerment, aligning with the objective of sustainable development and environmental conservation.
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Monitor Biodiversity in the Project Area

The Project's primary objective is to conserve biodiversity—such as mammals, birds, reptiles, amphibians, fishes, mollusks, invertebrates, and plants. To support this goal, the project will work with local communities to prevent deforestation and maintain forest integrity.

Activity description	Expected climate, community, and/or biodiversity			Relevance to project's objectives
	Outputs (short term)	Outcomes (medium term)	Impacts (long term)	
Avoid deforestation and monitor biodiversity	Identify camera models; identify local biologist; design study using wildlife cameras	Photographs of medium-to-large mammals; Updated IBAT report	Increased awareness of project area's biodiversity	Avoid deforestation to protect biodiversity

2.1.18 Sustainable Development Contributions (VCS, 3.17)

The project supports Gabon's national priorities in environmental and climate change, gender equality, governance, social cohesion, human development, and sustainable economic growth. It delivers environmental, social, governance, and economic benefits aligned with multiple UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

By reducing deforestation and degradation, the project protects forest ecosystems and biodiversity (SDG 15), including habitats for law-protected species such as African forest elephants and hippopotamus (SDG 15.5). It maintains vital ecosystem services like water regulation and carbon storage, supporting climate action (SDG 13) and aligning with the integration of climate measures into policies (SDG 13.2).

Socially, the project helps preserve cultural traditions tied to forests (SDG 11) and provides sustainable livelihoods through forest management. Revenue from carbon credits funds community projects such as schools, clinics, and infrastructure (SDGs 3, 4, 9). Activities like

agroforestry offer alternative incomes (SDG 8), while improved access to clean water (SDG 6) and renewable energy (SDG 7) enhance living conditions.

The project promotes transparency and combats illegal logging through sustainable forest management (SDG 16). It empowers women, youth, and other stakeholders via inclusive decision-making (SDGs 5, 10, 16.7), reducing conflict and strengthening governance.

Economically, the project generates revenue for national development, supports job creation in conservation, and reduces poverty (SDGs 1, 8). It advances Gabon's goal of sustainable and inclusive prosperity.

Through REDD+ implementation (SDG 15.2), the project ensures long-term forest and community sustainability. A dedicated monitoring team will ensure accurate data collection and reporting. Stakeholders, including government and communities, will receive regular updates and provide input, ensuring transparency and accountability in tracking progress toward Gabon's development goals.

2.1.19 Implementation Schedule (CCB, G1.9)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

2.1.20 Risks to the Project (CCB, G1.10)

Identified Risk	Potential impact of risk on climate, community and/or biodiversity benefits	Actions needed and designed to mitigate the risk
Landslides and Soil Erosion (Natural-induced)	The risk of landslides and soil erosion in the area is not widespread but is highly concentrated in specific vulnerable environments, primarily steep riverbanks. The risk is caused by the presence of inherently fragile terrain, such as steep slopes along major rivers. The process is catalyzed by the region's heavy equatorial rainfall, which rapidly erodes exposed soil and can trigger slope failures.	The project will implement strict management rules and maintain drainage infrastructure (ditches, culverts) with the objective of preventing soil erosion, protecting water quality, and enhancing the climate resilience of forest infrastructure.
Disorganized hunting (Human-induced)	Hunting is culturally significant and fundamental to the way of life of the indigenous communities residing in the project area. These activities are presumed to be conventional and low impact. On the other hand, hunting activities are conducted in a disorganized manner without monitoring or control, and have affected species protected under the Forest Code, which can be detrimental to the project's biodiversity goals.	If necessary, ENB will promote fauna monitoring with an emphasis on animal species, as well as environmental education initiatives.

Insufficient qualified and experienced personnel within the project management team. (Human-induced)	The project management team may face a shortage of personnel with adequate qualifications and relevant experience.	The project proponent maintains a dedicated human resources department and engages external consultants to design and implement comprehensive employee policies and benefits.
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2.1.21 Benefit Permanence (CCB, G1.11)

ENB are facilitating sustainable development across the project area by introducing alternative cash crops and economic opportunities to stimulate local growth. The project also tries to help local clans in addressing six priority demands: community projects, infrastructure development grants, future generation trusts, local savings and loan societies, financial literacy training, and micro- and small business support.

Through the promotion of sustainable practices and livelihood diversification, the project reduces high-impact activities such as resource overharvesting, thereby minimizing harm to biodiversity. These efforts are geared toward empowering communities economically while promoting habitat conservation.

To sustain and enhance biodiversity outcomes, the project emphasizes community involvement by collaborating with local clans to strengthen local capacity in resource management. Education and awareness initiatives are also implemented to instil conservation values across generations, targeting youth, community leaders, and the general public to foster lasting ecological stewardship.

2.1.22 Financial Sustainability (CCB, G1.12)

Project activities will be financed by the project proponents from the start date through the first verification. Following that, revenue generated from greenhouse gas (GHG) emission reductions will fund programs designed to amplify the project's climate, community, and biodiversity benefits. Evidence of the proponents' financial commitment will be provided to the validation and verification body.

2.2 Without-project Land Use Scenario and Additionality

2.2.1 Conditions Prior to Project Initiation and Land Use Scenarios without the Project (VCS, 3.13; CCB, G2.1)

The Grande Sun Project is in Gabon's Ogooué-Ivindo Province within a tropical rainforest ecosystem. This environment is marked by high levels of biodiversity, dense vegetation cover,

and substantial rainfall—all characteristic of the equatorial climate zone. The forest sustains a wide variety of plant and animal life, including numerous endemic species.

The Grande Sun Project area has long existed as a natural forest, remaining largely undisturbed by human activity, and retaining its forest cover over time. It currently continues to be predominantly wooded, providing essential habitat for native biodiversity while playing a key role in carbon storage and watershed conservation.

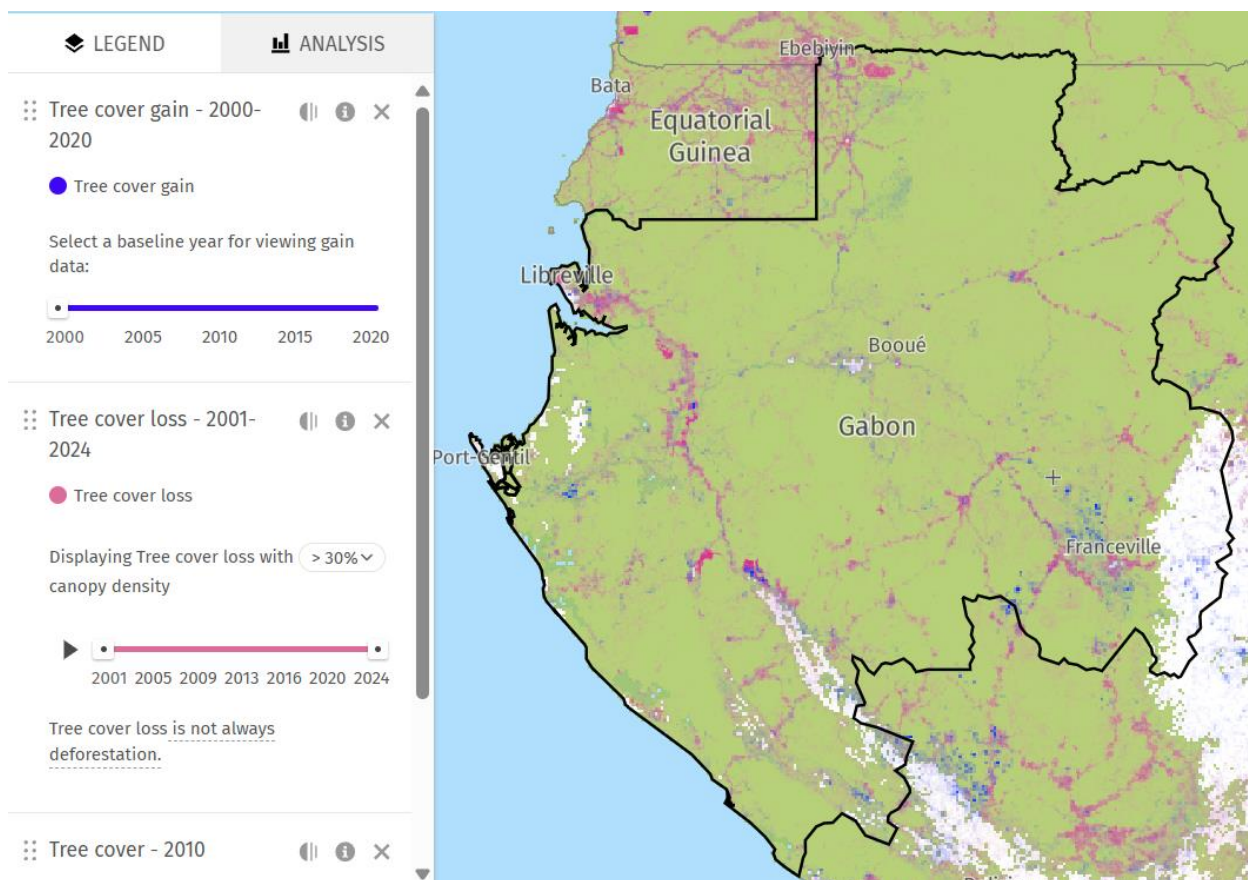
The project area exhibits a tropical rainforest climate, characterized by high humidity, stable temperatures, and substantial annual rainfall—averaging 1,680.6 mm. The region's terrain is part of the northern Gabon massif with geological formations including crystalline facies, associated pegmatites, and intrusions of basic and ultra-basic rocks. In terms of soils, there are deep ferralitic and kaolinitic soils, shallow stony soils formed on erosion-rejuvenated surfaces, and notable summit cuirasses (resistant to erosion) that contain exploitable iron ore; meanwhile, the soils are generally yellow and clayey (dominated by kaolinite) with fine structure ensuring good permeability but being quite fragile. The hydrology is complex, featuring a dense network of major rivers and their tributaries, specifically the Ivindo and Zadié rivers. The vegetation is not uniformly diverse but is overwhelmingly dominated by swamp forest. This single forest type constitutes 55.67% of the total area, defining the region's primary ecosystem. Please refer to 2.1.14 section for further details.

Based on the Provisional Convention on Development, Exploitation, and Transformation (CPAET) signed between ENB and the Gabonese Water and Forest Administration, ENB has obtained the rights for the industrial development of forest resources within the concession area. ENB is required to formulate a management plan and carry out related industrial development activities. Prior to the launch of the Grande Sun project, this forest area was slated for clearance as part of a scheduled logging operation. The project's mitigation measures to prevent planned deforestation will be implemented through enhanced local monitoring, partnerships with educational and research institutions, and providing benefits to neighboring communities. These efforts aim to minimize deforestation by offering alternative livelihoods, improved social services and infrastructure, education, and vocational training. For more details, please refer to Section 3.1.4.

Potential logging exploitation poses a threat to these woods, the biodiversity they contain, and the local population. The most likely outcome in the absence of the Grande Sun project is ongoing logging near accessible areas, followed by the expansion of the road system deep into the interior and upwards of the mountains. As of 2000, 93% of Gabon land cover was >30% tree cover. From 2000 to 2020, Gabon experienced a net change of -99 kha (-0.41%) in tree cover (Global Forest Watch)¹³.

For present and prior environmental conditions of the project area, please refer to section 2.1.14. For the baseline scenario, please refer to section 3.1.4.

¹³ GLOBAL FOREST WATCH: [Gabon Interactive Forest Map & Tree Cover Change Data](#) | GFW



2.2.2 Most-Likely Scenario Justification (CCB, G2.1)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

2.2.3 Community and Biodiversity Additionality (CCB, G2.2)

At present, no active initiatives are in place to reduce deforestation in the area, owing to limited governmental and local resources. Although the government of Gabon has implemented regulations banning the export of roundwood to curb illegal logging and harvesting, industrial logging continues to expand rapidly and shows a growing trend¹⁴. To the best of our knowledge, there are no other ongoing projects aimed at halting deforestation or promoting sustainable land management in the region. These factors clearly demonstrate that the proposed project activity meets the additionality requirement. For more detail on community and biodiversity without project scenario, please refer to section 4.1 and 5.1.

2.2.4 Benefits to be used as Offsets (CCB, G2.2)

¹⁴ Challenges for forest conservation in Gabon, Central Africa: [Challenges for forest conservation in Gabon, Central Africa - ScienceDirect](#)

The Grande Sun project does not intend to use any benefits to communities or biodiversity as offsets.

2.3 Safeguards and Stakeholder Engagement

2.3.1 Stakeholder Identification (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB G1.5)

The Grande Sun Project's Stakeholder Engagement Plan defines the strategies and methods for involving diverse stakeholder groups throughout the project. Its objective is to ensure inclusive participation and establish transparent communication channels to support information exchange, collaboration, and continuous feedback.

Key stakeholder groups were identified and categorized, including local and Indigenous communities, project proponents, government agencies and policymakers, non-governmental organizations (NGOs), as well as research and academic institutions. A stakeholder analysis was conducted to assess their interests, level of influence, and potential impact on the project, enabling the identification of key representatives within each group for targeted engagement.

Following stakeholder mapping, the project team initiated a consultation process using methods such as meetings, workshops, interviews, surveys, and focus groups. This approach ensures that all relevant parties have the opportunity to provide input, voice concerns, and help shape project design and implementation.

Stakeholder engagement is designed as an iterative process, incorporating ongoing monitoring and feedback mechanisms. As the project evolves, new stakeholders may be identified, and existing stakeholders' priorities may shift. Regular communication is maintained to keep all parties informed of project progress and to address emerging issues in a timely manner.

2.3.2 Stakeholder Descriptions (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G1.6, G1.13)

Stakeholder	Rights, interest, and overall relevance to the project
Local community	Right: - the right to a clean and healthy environment - The right to share in the benefits generated by the project. - The right to receive information and participate in consultations regarding decisions that impact their community. Interest: - forest preservation - community welfare - sustainable economic opportunities - skills and institutional development - involvement in decision-making processes Overall Relevance: The active involvement, support, and cooperation of local communities are critical to the project's success. Their participation is essential for effective forest conservation and the promotion of sustainable livelihoods. Respecting

	community rights, addressing concerns, and ensuring equitable sharing of project benefits are fundamental to building and sustaining positive community relations.
SOCIETE EXPORT NEGOCE DU BOIS (E.N.B)	Right: - the right to develop and implement the project in compliance with all relevant laws and regulations. - the right to a fair return on investment Interest: - emission reductions - financial viability - stakeholder engagement - reputation management Overall Relevance: The project proponent is responsible for the successful execution of the project. They supply essential resources, coordination, and management expertise. Key priorities include maintaining regulatory compliance, facilitating meaningful stakeholder engagement, and achieving emission reduction targets.
District and local level Governments	Right: - the right to participate in decision-making processes related to the project. - the right to receive information about the project's activities and impacts. - the right to advocate for the interests of the local community. Interest: - sustainable development - community welfare - environmental conservation - economic opportunities - capacity building - infrastructure development. Overall Relevance: The local government, representing community interests, plays an essential role in the project. It contributes to policy formation, land-use planning, and the coordination of local development efforts. Respecting its rights, involving it in project decisions, and addressing its concerns are vital to ensuring effective implementation and sustainable outcomes.
Gabon National Government	Right: - the right to participate in decision-making processes related to the project. - the right to receive project information and updates. - the right to advocate for national interests and policies. - the right to enforce environmental laws and regulations - the right to monitor biodiversity conservation, and protect Gabon's natural resources - the right to manage and regulate forest resources - the right to issue logging permits, and oversee sustainable forest management practices

	Interest: • forest conservation • climate change mitigation • sustainable development • international commitments • revenue generation • capacity building Overall Relevance: The Gabon National Government holds a significant role in the project as it is responsible for national policies, regulations, and international commitments related to forest conservation and climate change mitigation. Collaboration with the national government, addressing their interests, and aligning the project with national priorities are crucial for policy coherence, securing financial and technical support, and ensuring the project's long-term success.
Gabonese Water and Forest Administration (GWFA)	Right: • the right to coordinate and regulate climate change initiatives in Gabon. Interest: • mitigating climate change impacts • preserving Gabon's forests • promoting sustainable development Overall Relevance: The GWFA plays a crucial role in formulating policies, providing technical expertise, and overseeing the implementation of the project in Gabon. They ensure that the project aligns with national climate change strategies and promotes the country's sustainable development goals.
United Nations Food and Agriculture Organisation (UNFAO)– Gabon	Right: • the right to support and facilitate sustainable development initiatives, in collaboration with the Gabon government and other stakeholders. Interest: • promoting climate change mitigation • sustainable forest management • capacity building • poverty reduction Overall Relevance: UNFAO provides technical expertise and guidance on policy frameworks. They assist in project design, monitoring, and evaluation, ensuring that the project aligns with international standards and contributes to the achievement of sustainable development goals.
NGO	Right: • the right to advocate for environmental protection, community involvement, and the safeguarding of local rights and interests. Interest: • promoting environmental sustainability, social equity, empowerment of local communities, and inclusive participatory decision-making. Overall Relevance:

	NGOs play a key role in safeguarding the rights of local communities, facilitating multi-stakeholder consultations, and strengthening local capacity to support effective project execution.
Research & Educational Institutions	Right: - the right to conduct scientific research, provide technical expertise, and educate stakeholders on sustainable forest management and climate change. Interest: - generating knowledge - conducting research - capacity building - promoting evidence-based decision-making Overall Relevance: Research and educational institutions contribute to the project by conducting studies on forest carbon stocks, biodiversity, and socio-economic impacts. They provide technical guidance, training programs, and knowledge sharing platforms, fostering innovation and helping stakeholders make informed decisions.

2.3.3 Stakeholder Access to Project Documents (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G3.1)

Throughout project development and implementation, ENB will ensure full transparency by making all project documentation—including the project description, monitoring reports, and supporting materials—accessible to all affected and interested stakeholders. Booklets and flyers will also be distributed to summarize key project information in an easily understandable format, supporting effective communication.

The project employs the following mechanisms to ensure broad and inclusive information sharing:

- Printed Documentation:** Physical copies of project documents will be available at the offices of the Community Council and other designated local facilities. Given the limited internet connectivity and digital access in the local community, this approach ensures that all local residents and stakeholders can access relevant information. Booklets and flyers will be distributed during community engagement events and delivered household-to-household to maximize outreach coverage.
- Oral Communication:** Direct oral engagement has been a primary method for interacting with local communities. The project design was established through stakeholder workshops and community assemblies using oral communication. During project monitoring phases, additional meetings and engagement activities will be organized to update communities on project progress and outcomes.
- Online Publications:** Project documentation will also be published on the VCS and CCB websites to ensure global accessibility.

2.3.4 Dissemination of Summary Project Documents (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G3.1)

All communication channels outlined in Section 2.3.3 will be used to distribute project summaries. Summaries of project documentation and monitoring reports will be translated into French and indigenous languages to ensure accessibility and comprehension by community members. These summaries will be delivered and presented to relevant stakeholders through engagement activities such as workshops, meetings, and general assembly's once they become available.

The administration team will proactively coordinate the distribution of printed materials within local communities and hold regular meetings to keep stakeholders informed about project progress. Upon completion of the verification process, audited summary documents will also be published on the VCS and CCB websites. Additional copies will be provided to other interested stakeholders upon request.

2.3.5 Informational Meetings with Stakeholders (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G3.1)

Informational meetings with communities and local stakeholders constitute a fundamental component of the project's engagement and consultation strategy. These gatherings provide a structured platform to communicate project updates, solicit feedback, address concerns, and facilitate constructive dialogue between project implementers and community members.

In preparation for these meetings, the project team coordinates closely with local representatives, government agencies, and community leaders to select appropriate dates, times, and venues. Key considerations include accessibility, alignment with local schedules, and ensuring broad representation across stakeholder groups.

Publicity efforts are undertaken to ensure that community members and relevant stakeholders are aware of the meetings and have an opportunity to attend. Meetings for information are always advertised at least one month before our trip. Besides, the project remains engaged with communities through a dedicated team of Community Relations Officers (CROs), who provide ongoing updates via phone calls and messaging applications as new information or project milestones are achieved.

2.3.6 Risks from the Project and No Net Harm (VCS, 3.18, 3.19)

The project is dedicated to the conservation of pristine forest ecosystems. It refrains from any planned logging operations, focusing instead on maintaining the existing forest condition and preventing the introduction of new risks. No additional negative environmental impacts are anticipated from the project, as its activities do not involve pollutant emissions to air, wastewater discharge, noise or vibration, waste generation, or the use of hazardous substances, chemical pesticides, or fertilizers. For the project risk table, please see Appendix 3.

2.3.7 Community Costs, Risks, and Benefits (CCB, G3.2)

When meeting with local communities and indigenous people in the project area, ENB gathers information about costs, risks, and benefits using a simple and interactive community feedback approach. This approach was meant to figure out how well they understand things and what their current situation is like, so ENB can get a clearer picture of how to carry out this project. During these meetings, ENB explained to the community what costs, risks, and benefits mean, and ENB encouraged them to share any possible effects they thought the carbon credit project might have. The discussion was led by experts who made sure to talk in a way that everyone there could easily understand. Therefore, through this two-way conversation, the community concluded from this comparison and their discussions that their community conservation efforts will bring them more benefits than logging due to the following main rationale:

- Local communities widely recognize and highly value the forest's role in conservation and its positive contributions to climate stability and biodiversity protection.
- Communities have observed that deforestation has resulted in biodiversity loss and increased vulnerability to natural disasters.
- The national government is supportive on REDD+ projects, but not deforestation activities such as logging.

2.3.8 Information to Stakeholders on Validation and Verification Process (VCS, 3.18.6, 3.19; CCB, G3.3)

During community meetings, detailed information was shared with the local community regarding the validation and verification process, covering its purpose, procedures, and logistical arrangements. It was clarified that Project Documents aligned with VCS and CCB standards must be prepared and undergo rigorous validation and verification. Community members acknowledged that their active support and coordination are vital to the success of the VCS+CCB audit, which is required for the issuance of carbon credits.

The following key points were also communicated:

Project Design and Implementation: The project's objectives, anticipated outcomes, and current monitoring results were presented to maintain full transparency.

- **Risks, Costs, and Benefits:** A comprehensive overview of potential risks, costs, and benefits for stakeholders was provided to facilitate informed understanding.
- **Benefit Sharing Mechanism:** The framework for equitable distribution of project benefits among stakeholders was described where applicable.
- **Ongoing FPIC Process:** Updates were given on the Free, Prior, and Informed Consent (FPIC) process to reaffirm respect for community rights and input.

- **Workers' Rights:** Relevant national laws and regulations pertaining to workers' rights were outlined to underscore the project's adherence to legal standards.
- **Validation and Verification:** The role of auditors, steps involved in the VCS verification process, and expectations for community interaction during site visits were explained to foster collaborative engagement.

The reliability and precision of information contributed by local communities are essential to the validation and verification process.

2.3.9 Site Visit Information and Opportunities to Communicate with Auditor (VCS, 3.18.6; CCB, G3.3)

The local community will receive notification of the anticipated auditor visit at least one month ahead of time. Upon confirmation of the exact date, the community leader will be promptly informed via mobile phone and will subsequently relay the information to other villagers. All relevant stakeholders will simultaneously receive formal written notification by email.

ENB will coordinate all logistical arrangements for the auditor team's site visit. On the day of the audit, the auditors will be introduced to the community in a public gathering, during which the scope and methodology of the audit will be explained. Focus group discussions will be organized to facilitate structured dialogue. The meetings will include representatives from local communities, municipal government bodies, and district development authorities. Community representatives will be present throughout the audit activities to provide direct responses to auditor inquiries, ensuring transparency and supporting the effective exchange of information.

2.3.10 Stakeholder Consultations (VCS, 3.18; CCB, G3.4)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

2.3.11 Continued Consultation and Adaptive Management (VCS, 3.18; CCB, G3.4)

All stakeholders are encouraged to submit comments and input throughout the duration of the project. Feedback received will be regularly reviewed and evaluated by the relevant committees. Written responses will be provided to indicate how each input was considered and whether it led to any adjustments in project management.

Annual monitoring and evaluation meetings will be convened to collect feedback from key stakeholders. Attendance will be requested from members of the Management Committee and the Project Development Committee, which include representatives of the project proponents and local communities. Agenda items will cover project implementation and monitoring, budget and investment status, priority actions, key updates, summaries of stakeholder feedback, and proposed management adaptations. Meeting notes and outcomes will be disseminated to relevant stakeholders following each session for reference and implementation.

2.3.12 Stakeholder Consultation Channels (CCB, G3.5)

Demonstrate that all consultations and participatory processes have been undertaken directly with communities and other stakeholders or through their legitimate representatives. Provide justification that adequate levels of information sharing have occurred.

At every stakeholder engagement meeting or workshop, all participants are encouraged to share their comments and input openly. Stakeholders are also welcome to use alternative communication channels after the session for further discussion. A designated contact person is introduced during these events to address any future questions or feedback. Email addresses for reaching relevant committees are made available to all community members.

2.3.13 Stakeholder Participation in Decision-Making and Implementation (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G3.6)

To ensure meaningful and inclusive participation of all community groups throughout the project's lifecycle—from design and implementation to monitoring and evaluation—a culturally responsive and comprehensive engagement strategy has been established. The following measures form the core of this approach:

1. Participatory Workshops

- **Inclusive Engagement:** Workshops are designed to include diverse community segments such as women, youth, and representatives from various clans, creating a platform for sharing local knowledge, perceptions, and expectations.
- **Cultural Respect:** All sessions are organized in a manner that honors local customs and traditions. Facilitators receive training to promote a respectful and inclusive environment.
- **Accessible Communication:** Sessions are conducted in local languages to enable full comprehension and participation. Interpretation services are provided as needed to ensure clear dialogue.

2. Stakeholder Committees

- **Representative Governance:** Committees include members from different clans, women, and youth to incorporate diverse community perspectives into project decision-making.
- **Equitable Representation:** Following Gabon Government guidelines, the project has secured formal consent from most community members, which serves as a clear indication of its wide-ranging support within the community.
- **Transparent Operations:** Meetings are conducted with transparency, and minutes and key decisions are shared openly with the community to maintain accountability and build trust.

3. Free, Prior, and Informed Consent (FPIC)

- Awareness Activities: FPIC awareness initiatives—including community meetings, informational sessions, and the distribution of educational materials—have been conducted to ensure all community members are fully informed about the project and its potential impacts. For further details, refer to Section 2.5.7.
- Consent Requirement: In compliance with Gabon Government guidelines, formal consent has been obtained from a large majority of community members, demonstrating broad community support for the project.
- Ongoing Engagement: FPIC is maintained as a continuous process, with regular updates provided to the community and ongoing opportunities for feedback throughout the project lifecycle.

4. Monitoring and Evaluation

- Participatory Monitoring: Community members, including women and youth, are actively involved in data collection, outcome analysis, and identifying areas for improvement.
- Structured Feedback Channels: Accessible feedback mechanisms—such as community meetings, suggestion boxes, and digital platforms—enable continuous community input.
- Cultural Relevance: All monitoring and evaluation activities are designed to be culturally appropriate and accessible to ensure meaningful participation.

5. Capacity Building

- Skill Development: Training sessions and workshops are offered to community members, with emphasis on women and youth, covering project management, leadership, and relevant technical skills.
- Community Empowerment: These initiatives aim to strengthen local capacity and encourage active involvement, fostering a strong sense of ownership and commitment to the project's success.

Through these measures, the project promotes inclusive and equitable engagement of all community segments—including women, youth, and diverse clans—in every phase from design to evaluation. This approach enhances both the fairness and long-term sustainability of the project.

2.3.14 Anti-Discrimination Assurance (VCS 3.19; CCB, G3.7)

To foster an environment of inclusivity, diversity, and respect, and to prevent all forms of discrimination and sexual harassment, the following key measures have been implemented:

1. Non-Discrimination and Anti-Harassment Policy:

A clear and comprehensive policy has been established that explicitly prohibits discrimination and sexual harassment on the basis of gender, race, religion, sexual orientation, or other protected characteristics. This policy is communicated to all project participants and is readily accessible.

2. Training and Awareness Initiatives:

Regular training sessions and awareness programs are conducted for project staff, consultants, contractors, and community members. These initiatives focus on understanding and preventing discrimination and harassment, highlighting their harmful effects, and reinforcing the importance of a safe and respectful working environment. Guidance on expected conduct and reporting procedures is also provided.

3. Equal Opportunity and Inclusive Practices:

The project ensures equal opportunities for all individuals, irrespective of gender, race, religion, sexual orientation, or other attributes. Diversity and inclusion are actively promoted within project decision-making, employment, and community engagement processes.

4. Grievance Mechanisms

A formal and confidential grievance mechanism has been established, enabling individuals to report cases of discrimination or harassment without fear of retaliation. Clear reporting—such as dedicated hotlines, email addresses, and designated staff—are communicated to all stakeholders.

5. Investigation and Accountability

A well-defined process is in place to ensure reported incidents are investigated promptly, impartially, and transparently. Appropriate disciplinary actions, including sanctions, are enforced against those found responsible.

6. Monitoring and Reporting

The effectiveness of anti-discrimination and anti-harassment measures is regularly monitored and evaluated. Findings are included in project progress reports, with transparency maintained regarding incident reports, investigations, and corrective actions.

7. Collaboration with Local Communities

Local communities are actively engaged to incorporate their needs, concerns, and perspectives into project activities. Community representatives participate in project decision-making to help ensure their rights are respected throughout the project lifecycle.

8. Partnerships and Due Diligence

Due diligence is conducted on all partner organizations, contractors, and consultants to verify their adherence to policies preventing discrimination and harassment. Partnerships are prioritized with entities that demonstrate a strong commitment to equity and inclusion.

ENB considers the integration of these measures into the project's governance framework essential to building a culture of respect, fairness, and equality. These protocols will be periodically reviewed and updated to maintain their relevance and effectiveness over the course of the project.

2.3.15 Feedback and Grievance Redress Procedure (VCS, 3.18.4; CCB, G3.8)

Development process	Describe the process used to develop the grievance redress procedure including processes for receiving, hearing, responding, and attempting to resolve grievances within a reasonable time period, taking into account culturally appropriate conflict resolution methods.
Grievance redress procedure	<i>Describe the grievance redress procedures developed with stakeholders. Demonstrate that the procedure includes:</i> <i>A process for receiving, hearing, responding to and attempting to resolve grievances within a reasonable time period, which takes into account traditional conflict resolution methods.</i> <i>Three stages, each with reasonable time limits: attempt at resolution, mediation and arbitration or courts.</i>

2.3.16 Accessibility of the Feedback and Grievance Redress Procedure (VCS, 3.19; CCB, G3.8)

To address the requirements for documenting and publicly sharing the feedback and grievance redress procedure, ENB has outlined the following approach:

1. Publicity and Accessibility

- The grievance procedure will be disseminated through multiple channels to ensure broad accessibility, including community notice boards, stakeholder meetings, and local media.
- The procedure will be provided in multiple languages to reflect the linguistic diversity of local communities.
- Printed copies will be available at community centers, project offices, and other accessible locations to serve stakeholders with limited internet access.

2. Grievance Submission

- Clear and varied submission channels will be established, such as a dedicated hotline, email address, physical drop boxes, and designated contact personnel.
- Submission forms will be offered in multiple formats—including online forms, printable PDFs, and disability-accessible versions—to accommodate diverse needs.

3. Documentation and Transparency

- All grievances will be systematically recorded, including submission date, nature of the issue, and supporting documents, while maintaining strict confidentiality of grievant information.
- Project responses will be thoroughly documented, including timelines, investigative steps, resolutions, and outcomes, with summaries made publicly available to ensure transparency.

4. Public Availability of Information

- To ensure transparency, aggregated and anonymized grievance data—including types of issues and their resolutions—will be publicly shared via community notice boards and stakeholder meetings.
- Periodic reports summarizing grievance trends, response timelines, and outcomes will be published and distributed to relevant stakeholders, regulatory authorities, and other interested parties as applicable.

5. Privacy and Confidentiality

- The privacy and confidentiality of grievant will be strictly maintained through secure handling and storage of personal information. Access to sensitive data will be restricted to authorized personnel involved in the redress process.
- Responses to grievances will be communicated to individuals in a manner that upholds confidentiality while clearly explaining actions taken and results achieved.

The feedback and grievance mechanism are designed to be widely accessible, transparent, and trustworthy, thereby strengthening stakeholder engagement throughout the project.

2.3.17 Worker Training (VCS, 3.19; CCB, G3.9)

ENB has developed a structured training program for both project employees and community participants, designed to build local capacity and reduce dependency on external personnel. The approach includes comprehensive orientation and skill-building sessions aimed at empowering community members and ensuring the retention of knowledge and operational continuity, even amid staff changes.

These efforts support sustainable development by fostering local ownership, enhancing self-reliance, and strengthening long-term engagement among stakeholders.

Measures	Description
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<i>Orientation and Training Programs</i>	• Develop comprehensive orientation programs for all project employees and relevant community members involved in project activities. • The orientation program should include an introduction to the project's goals, objectives, and activities, as well as an overview of the grievance redress procedure and the importance of stakeholder engagement. • Provide training on relevant technical skills, such as sustainable resource management practices, data collection and analysis, project monitoring and evaluation, and any other skills specific to the project's activities. • Training programs should be designed to be participatory and interactive, incorporating both theoretical and practical components to enhance learning effectiveness.
<i>Localized Skills and Knowledge</i>	• Design training programs with a focus on building locally useful skills and knowledge to increase local participation in project implementation. • Engage local experts, community leaders, and traditional knowledge holders to contribute to the training programs, ensuring that local perspectives and traditional practices are incorporated. • Foster a participatory learning environment that encourages the sharing of local knowledge and experiences among participants, promoting a sense of ownership and empowerment.
<i>Training Documentation and Resources</i>	• Develop training materials and resources that are accessible, culturally appropriate, and available in local languages. • Document training sessions, including presentations, handouts, and practical exercises, to create a repository of knowledge that can be referred to and shared with new employees and community members in the future.
<i>Continuous Learning and Development</i>	• Establish a system for ongoing learning and development to ensure that skills and knowledge are continuously built upon and updated. • Encourage employees and community members to participate in relevant workshops, seminars, and capacity-building opportunities outside the project scope. • Foster a culture of learning and knowledge sharing within the project team, promoting regular meetings, discussions, and peer-to-peer learning sessions.
<i>Succession Planning and Knowledge Transfer</i>	• Implement a succession planning strategy to mitigate the loss of local capacity through staff turnover. • Identify potential local leaders or community members who can be trained to take on key roles within the project.

	- Facilitate knowledge transfer by encouraging departing employees to document and share their experiences, lessons learned, and best practices with their successors. - Foster mentorship programs that pair experienced employees with new recruits or community members, facilitating knowledge sharing and skill development.
<i>Evaluation and Feedback</i>	- Regularly evaluate the effectiveness of the orientation and training programs through feedback sessions, surveys, and assessments. - Solicit input from participants to identify areas for improvement and to ensure that the training programs are meeting their needs and expectations. - Consider feedback from community members and employees when designing and updating future training initiatives.
<i>Succession Planning and Knowledge Transfer</i>	- Implement a succession planning strategy to mitigate the loss of local capacity through staff turnover. - Identify potential local leaders or community members who can be trained to take on key roles within the project. - Facilitate knowledge transfer by encouraging departing employees to document and share their experiences, lessons learned, and best practices with their successors. - Foster mentorship programs that pair experienced employees with new recruits or community members, facilitating knowledge sharing and skill development.
<i>Evaluation and Feedback</i>	- Regularly evaluate the effectiveness of the orientation and training programs through feedback sessions, surveys, and assessments. - Solicit input from participants to identify areas for improvement and to ensure that the training programs are meeting their needs and expectations. - Consider feedback from community members and employees when designing and updating future training initiatives.

2.3.18 Community Employment Opportunities (VCS, 3.19.13; CCB, G3.10)

ENB has established a human resources recruitment policy and a compensation and benefits framework to ensure a fair and transparent selection process for community-based employment opportunities. A regularly updated staff list is maintained, and the following measures will be implemented:

1. Fair and Transparent Recruitment and Selection Criteria

Define clear and specific job requirements, qualifications, and necessary skills for each position, ensuring alignment with actual job responsibilities.

Establish selection criteria that are objective, measurable, and strictly job-related, avoiding any elements that could introduce bias or discrimination—particularly against women, vulnerable groups, or marginalized communities.

2. Standardized Application and Objective Evaluation Process

Implement a standardized application form or online platform to collect essential candidate information uniformly.

Screen all applications against predefined job-related criteria to identify candidates meeting the minimum qualifications.

Apply a structured scoring or rating system to objectively assess and compare applicants' qualifications, skills, and experience.

3. Diverse Evaluation and Structured Interview Framework

Form a diverse evaluation panel with members trained in impartial and unbiased assessment methods.

Include representatives from varied backgrounds and areas of expertise to reduce individual bias and incorporate multiple perspectives into decision-making.

Conduct structured interviews and assessments using pre-defined questions and consistent evaluation criteria to maintain fairness and comparability.

4. Assessment of Job-Related Competencies

Design job-aligned assessment methods—such as practical tasks, simulations, or work samples—to directly evaluate candidates' competencies.

Ensure all assessments reflect actual job requirements and responsibilities to maintain relevance and accuracy.

Provide candidates with clear instructions and evaluation criteria beforehand to ensure transparency and preparedness.

5. Transparent Selection Process and Feedback Mechanism

Clearly outline the selection process—including timelines, stages, and evaluation standards—to all applicants at the outset.

Keep candidates informed at each phase of the process, such as application review, interviews, and assessments.

Offer constructive feedback to unsuccessful candidates to clarify decision rationale and support their future improvement.

6. Documentation and Record Keeping

Maintain comprehensive records of the selection process, including applications, evaluation scores, interview notes, and assessment outcomes.

Securely and confidentially store all records to ensure privacy and compliance with data protection regulations.

Document the rationale for candidate selection or non-selection based on predefined criteria to demonstrate procedural transparency and fairness.

7. Regular Review and Improvement

Conduct regular reviews of the selection process to identify potential biases, inconsistencies, or areas needing improvement.

Collect feedback from both selection panel members and applicants to evaluate the process's fairness and effectiveness.

Implement necessary adjustments based on review findings to ensure ongoing improvement and adherence to equitable practices.

8. Job Evaluation and Salary Standardization

Establish a quantifiable job evaluation system based on factors such as complexity of duties, skill requirements, working conditions, and scope of responsibility.

Define standardized salary ranges according to evaluation outcomes to ensure consistency and transparency in remuneration for the same or similar roles.

9. Pay Equity Auditing and Process Transparency

Conduct regular pay equity audits to analyze compensation distribution differences among various groups (e.g., gender, region) in comparable positions.

Publicly disclose salary determination principles and adjustment mechanisms, ensuring that compensation decisions are traceable, explainable, and accessible to all employees.

10. Bias Prevention and Complaint Mechanism

Incorporate pay equity principles into management training to improve recognition and mitigation of unconscious bias.

Establish an anonymous channel for remuneration complaints, allowing employees to request pay reviews, with designated personnel processing and responding within a defined timeframe.

2.3.19 Occupational Safety Assessment (VCS, 3.19; CCB, G3.12)

Workers involved in the Grande Sun project face risks commonly associated with outdoor field activities. To mitigate these risks and ensure that all personnel are adequately informed and protected, ENB has established "Occupational Health and Safety Guidelines" and "Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) Guidelines" to inform workers about potential risks and supply

them with the necessary knowledge and tools to minimize such risks. This approach contributes to a safer work environment and helps reduce occupational hazards and accidents.

ENB also ensures that all distributed PPE meets relevant safety standards, is properly fitted, and is regularly maintained. In addition, training is provided to workers on the correct use, maintenance, and storage of PPE to maximize its protective effectiveness.

To provide further detail, the specific potential risks and corresponding mitigation measures are outlined below:

Risk Type	Risk description	Measures
Physical Hazards	Performing tasks in remote or difficult terrain, which may include uneven ground, steep slopes, and challenging weather conditions.	- Perform comprehensive site assessments and surveys to identify physical hazards and develop tailored mitigation plans. - Deliver targeted training on safe work practices, including equipment operation and navigation in difficult terrain. - Equip all personnel with suitable personal protective equipment (PPE), such as non-slip footwear, helmets, and weather-appropriate clothing. - Implement clear communication protocols and emergency response procedures to ensure worker safety in isolated locations.
Machinery and Equipment	Operating heavy machinery, tools, or equipment—such as chainsaws or vehicles—that may pose risks of accidents and injuries if handled improperly.	- Provide thorough training on the safe operation, maintenance, and hazard awareness related to machinery and equipment. - Conduct regular inspections and maintenance of all equipment to ensure optimal and safe working condition. - Mandate the use of appropriate safety devices, protective guards, and operational controls on all machinery. - Establish and enforce strict operational protocols, including supervised use and adherence to documented safety procedures.
Risk of accidents with venomous animals	Workers in the project area face a potential risk of encounters with venomous animals, particularly snakes, due to the remote wilderness conditions and significant distance from the nearest healthcare facility.	- Provide all field personnel with snake-resistant gaiters and enforce their mandatory use during movement within the project zone. - Conduct regular training on venomous species identification, safe movement practices in wilderness areas, and emergency first-aid response for snakebites. - Establish a rapid-response protocol and emergency communication system to coordinate medical evacuation and treatment in case of an incident, given the remote location of the project.

2.4 Management Capacity

2.4.1 Project Governance Structures (CCB, G4.1)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

2.4.2 Required Technical Skills (VCS, 3.19; CCB, G4.2)

To better support the project implementation, the following skills are those that ENB and its team already possess:

- Community Engagement: Conduct stakeholder engagement and possess strong communication, facilitation, and conflict resolution skills.
- Social Impact Assessment: Conduct social impact assessments, community surveys, and use participatory approaches to understand and address community concerns.
- Biodiversity Assessment and Conservation: Conduct biodiversity assessments, including species identification, habitat mapping, and ecological surveys.
- Carbon Measurement and Monitoring - Carbon Accounting: Quantify emissions and carbon sequestration to measure the project's carbon footprint and track progress towards emission reduction targets.
- Carbon Measurement and Monitoring - Monitoring and Evaluation: Design and implement monitoring and evaluation systems to assess the project's environmental and social performance; collect relevant data, establish indicators, and analyze the project's progress against sustainability goals.

2.4.3 Management Team Experience (VCS, 3.19; CCB, G4.2)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance with Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

2.4.4 Project Management Partnerships and Team Development (VCS, 3.19; CCB, G4.2)

To better complement project management expertise and address identified capacity gaps, strategic partnerships have been formed with specialized organizations. These collaborations ensure access to necessary expertise and resources for successful project implementation. A targeted recruitment strategy has been developed to address remaining gaps within the management team. This approach includes:

- Identifying specific areas where expertise is currently lacking;

- Conducting a detailed assessment of required skills, experience, and qualifications for each role;
- Actively recruiting qualified professionals through targeted campaigns, industry networks, and partnerships with academic institutions;
- Implementing a rigorous selection process to evaluate candidates' qualifications and alignment with project goals and values.

Through strategic partnerships and a structured recruitment process, the project will be supported by a highly capable and diverse management team equipped to meet all requirements and ensure successful delivery.

2.4.5 Financial Health of Implementing Organization(s) (CCB, G4.3)

Sufficient resources have been secured to ensure full operational capacity and cover all associated expenses. ENB maintains a record clear of any fraud, asset misappropriation, financial statement manipulation, corruption, money laundering, or significant financial distress. The entity operates without debt and settles all invoices in a timely manner. Furthermore, ENB's marketing partner has guaranteed that the highest available market price will be obtained for remaining carbon credits once issued.

2.4.6 Avoidance of Corruption and Other Unethical Behavior (VCS, 3.19; CCB, G4.3)

A zero-tolerance management mechanism is enforced against corruption, bribery, embezzlement, fraud, favoritism, cronyism, nepotism, extortion, and collusion. The following measures have been implemented to ensure accountability and ethical conduct:

Code of Conduct and Compliance Policies: A comprehensive Code of Conduct and compliance framework has been established, outlining ethical standards and behavioral expectations for all project participants, including team members, contractors, suppliers, and partners. These policies explicitly prohibit corrupt or unethical actions and provide clear guidelines for conduct.

Anti-Corruption Training and Awareness: Regular training sessions and awareness programs are conducted to educate all stakeholders on preventing corruption and unethical behavior. The curriculum covers types of corruption, legal implications, reporting channels, and consequences of violations, fostering a culture of integrity and vigilance.

Transparent Procurement and Vendor Selection: Rigorous procurement processes are applied, incorporating competitive bidding, predefined evaluation criteria, and due diligence assessments. All procurement activities—including proposal requests, bid evaluations, and contract awards—are thoroughly documented to ensure fairness and mitigate risks of favoritism or collusion.

Whistleblower Mechanism: A confidential and accessible reporting channel allows individuals to safely report suspected unethical conduct without fear of retaliation. The mechanism

guarantees whistleblower anonymity and ensures that all reports are promptly and thoroughly investigated.

Third-Party Audits and Compliance Reviews: Independent auditors conduct periodic evaluations of project processes, financial records, and implementation activities to identify irregularities or non-compliance.

2.4.7 Commercially Sensitive Information (VCS, 3.5.2 – 3.5.4; CCB Rules, 3.5.13 – 3.5.14)

No commercially sensitive information has been excluded.

2.5 Legal Status and Property Rights

2.5.1 National and Local Laws (VCS, 3.1, 3.6, 3.7, 3.14, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G5.6)

This section outlines the compliance of the project with relevant legal and regulatory requirements in the jurisdiction of Gabon¹⁵, ensuring that all activities adhere to local, national, and international laws, statutes, and other regulatory frameworks applicable to the Grande Sun projects.

Regulatory Framework	Description	Project compliance
Gabonese CONSTITUTION Loi N° 3/91 du 26 Mars 1991	The Constitution of the Gabonese Republic was promulgated in 1991. It was amended in 1994, 1995, 1997, 2000, 2003, 2011, 2018, 2023, and 2024. Law no. 001/2018 of 12 January 2018 constitutionalised part of the reform of the institutions. It contains democratic advances, including positive discrimination in favour of women and a return to two-round elections.	The Project Proponents will adhere to all applicable local, regional, and national laws, regulations, and standards. None of the proposed project activities within the Project Area contravene any legal or constitutional provisions.
Law No. 016-01 on the Forest Code in the Gabonese Republic. (Loi n° 016-01 portant code forestier en République gabonaise. ¹⁶)	The project will develop and implement a comprehensive Forest Management Plan in accordance with the Gabonese Forest Code, ensuring sustainable forest management that minimize environmental impacts. The main goals of the 2001 Forest Code were to foster: (1) the sustainable development of forests; (2) the industrialization of the Gabonese timber sector; (3) the sustainable conservation of natural resources, and (4) greater local stakeholder involvement in the management of Gabon's natural resources (including indigenous and tribal peoples).	The land within the Project Area is owned by the Government of the Republic of Gabon, with ENB holding legal concession rights. These rights, granted for specific periods through government-approved agreements, authorize ENB to operate within the designated zone.

¹⁵ FAO (Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations), FAOLEX Country Profile – Gabon
<https://www.fao.org/faolex/country-profiles/general-profile/en/?iso3=GAB>

¹⁶ <https://www.fao.org/faolex/results/details/en/c/LEX-FAOC029255>

Law No. 002/2014 of August 1, 2014, on the orientation of sustainable development in the Gabonese Republic. (Loi n° 002/2014 du 01 août 2014 portant orientation du développement durable en République gabonaise¹⁷)	In 2014, Gabon enacted its General Law on Sustainable Development, establishing a national framework that mandates companies to offset environmental and social impacts through the purchase of sustainable development credits—such as carbon, biodiversity, ecosystem, and community credits—within a national trading system. The law anchors sustainable development as a constitutional principle (Article 47) and outlines a national strategy centred on intergenerational well-being. It requires policies, programs, and projects to align with sustainable development objectives, limits harmful activities, and introduces offsetting obligations through credit acquisition. Key implementation measures include: - Registering and controlling sustainable development assets; - Maintaining a national registry for policies, projects, concessions, rights, and credits; - Creating tradable and securable sustainable development credits; - Establishing financial mechanisms and oversight institutions to ensure credit reliability and national consistency; - Implementing fiscal incentives and monitoring systems to promote sustainable practices. An institutional framework led by the National Council for Sustainable Development and designated management bodies is established to oversee execution.	Concession areas in Gabon are administered by the Ministry of Forestry, which oversees their allocation and ensures compliance with national forest legislation as outlined in the country's Forestry Code. The Grande Sun REDD+ Project aligns with Gabon's General Law on Sustainable Development by: - Generating and transacting verified carbon credits, which function as sustainable development credits under the national framework; - Contributing to biodiversity and ecosystem conservation, community well-being, and climate mitigation—core pillars of Gabon's sustainable development strategy; - Operating within a transparent registry and monitoring system to ensure credit integrity and compliance with national standards; - Supporting local livelihoods and sustainable economic alternatives, thereby offsetting potential environmental impacts through tangible community and ecological benefits. Through these actions, the project embodies the law's emphasis on credit-based compensation, sustainable
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¹⁷ <https://www.fao.org/faolex/results/details/en/c/LEX-FAOC174569/>

		resource management, and nationally consistent climate and development practices.
Loi CAFI-GABON	In 2017, the Central Africa Forest Initiative (CAFI) signed a letter of intent in which CAFI pledged \$18 million to support forest monitoring (among other activities), which ultimately laid the groundwork for the \$150 million results-based payment signed in 2019. In 2019, Gabon and CAFI also signed an amendment to the letter of intent, worth \$150 million, which rewards the country over 10 years both for reducing its GHG emissions from deforestation and forest degradation, and for the carbon absorbed by natural forests. The methodology proposed in the CAFI3 agreement is not adapted to forest concessions.	The Grande Sun project is not included in this period, so there is no double counting.
Gabon's national REDD+ strategy	The CNC released Gabon's national REDD+ strategy in 2022, with the aim of defining the country's commitments and objectives with regard to this mechanism at national level. The intention is to extend RIL-C practices to all forestry companies. Based in particular on Gabon's Proposed National REDD+ Forest Reference Level (FRL) ¹⁸ of 2021 and the second version of Gabon's CDN¹⁹ of 2022.	The Grande Sun project is part of Gabon's commitment, which is voluntary rather than mandatory.
Loi n° 022/2021 du 19 novembre 2021 portant Code du Travail en République gabonaise,	Labour codes, general labour acts, organizing International Labour Repetition (ILO).	The Project Proponents will comply with all applicable local, district and national laws, regulations and standards. Within the Project Area, none of the proposed Project Activities violate any laws or regulations.
International Conventions	Compliance with international agreements ratified by Gabon, such as the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD), the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC), and the Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora (CITES).	

2.5.2 Relevant Laws and Regulations Related to Worker's Rights (VCS, 3.18.2; CCB, G3.11)

¹⁸ https://redd.unfccc.int/files/gabon_frl_submitted_feb2021.pdf

¹⁹ https://unfccc.int/sites/default/files/NDC/2022-07/20220706_Gabon_Updated%20NDC.pdf

Regulatory Framework	Description	Project compliance
Loi n° 022/2021 du 19 novembre 2021 portant Code du Travail en République gabonaise,	The law was formulated in accordance with Article 47 of Gabon's Constitution, aiming to regulate labor relations between workers and employers, as well as between employers (or their representatives) and apprentices/trainees under their management. It consists of 413 articles divided into 8 parts, namely: General Provisions, Labor Contracts, General Working Conditions, Occupational Safety and Health, Enforcement Bodies and Means, Occupational Organizations, Labor Disputes, and Transitional and Final Provisions. This law strengthens the protection of workers, aims to eliminate gender discrimination and inequality in employment, opens up the formal labor market to new types of work, establishes flexible contracts to enhance youth employability, and promotes social dialogue within companies.	The Grande Sun Project has implemented the following measures to inform all workers of their rights in accordance with Gabon's Labour Code: - Rights Awareness: Conducted mandatory training sessions for all workers, including contract employees, apprentices, and interns, to educate them on their entitlements under Gabon's labour legislation—such as fair remuneration, rest periods, health and safety protections, and the right to work free from discrimination, harassment, or forced labour. - Multilingual Labour Rights Documentation: Developed and distributed easy-to-understand summaries of key labour rights in local languages, posted in common areas and included in worker onboarding materials, ensuring all personnel can access and comprehend their legal protections. - Clear Anti-Harassment and Grievance Protocols Established and communicated a zero-tolerance policy towards all forms of harassment (psychological and sexual), with defined reporting channels and assurance of non-retaliation, in alignment with the Labour Code's disciplinary and judicial requirements. - Ongoing Communication and Accessible Support: Implemented regular updates through noticeboards, team meetings, and digital platforms to keep workers informed of their rights. Designated labour rights officers are available to provide confidential guidance and assist with any concerns related to working conditions or rights violations. These measures ensure that every worker involved in the project is fully aware of their rights and the mechanisms available to

safeguard their well-being and dignity in the workplace.

2.5.3 Human Rights (VCS, 3.19)

The project is committed to recognizing, respecting, and advancing the rights of Indigenous Peoples (IPs), Local Communities (LCs), and customary rights holders in accordance with international human rights standards, including the UN Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (UNDRIP) and ILO Convention 169. Key measures implemented to uphold these rights include:

1. Free, Prior, and Informed Consent (FPIC):

FPIC is sought from IPs, LCs, and customary rights holders for any activities affecting their lands, territories, or resources. Engagement is conducted transparently, with full access to information and without coercion.

2. Resource Rights:

The project recognizes the rights of communities to own, use, and manage their lands and resources according to custom and traditive displacement and protects communal territories and sacred sites.

3. Cultural Heritage and Traditional Knowledge:

Cultural expressions, languages, and traditional knowledge are respected and protected. The project ensures communities provide consent before their knowledge is used and promotes equitable benefit-sharing from such practices.

4. Non-Discrimination and Equality:

Inclusive participation of IPs and LCs is prioritized in project decision-making. The project ensures their voices are heard and perspectives integrated, free from discrimination.

5. Social and Economic Development:

Efforts are made to enhance community well-being through capacity building, education, healthcare, and economic opportunities, aligning with local aspirations and supporting self-determined development.

6. Remedies and Redress:

Accessible and fair grievance mechanisms are provided, ensuring that any rights violations or disputes are addressed through transparent and culturally appropriate processes.

7. Collaboration and Partnership:

The project works in close partnership with IPs, LCs, and their representative organizations, treating them as essential stakeholders and rights holders throughout all project phases.

By embedding these principles into its operations and governance, the project affirms its alignment with international human rights norms and its dedication to protecting the rights of indigenous and local communities.

2.5.4 Indigenous Peoples and Cultural Heritage (VCS, 3.18, 3.19)

While environmental outcomes are central to its mission, equal importance is placed on respecting and preserving the cultural heritage of Indigenous Peoples as a core component of project activities.

Through meaningful partnerships and adherence to Free, Prior, and Informed Consent (FPIC), the project engages Indigenous communities in planning, execution, and monitoring, embedding cultural considerations from the earliest stages.

Sacred sites and culturally significant landscapes—often repositories of traditional wisdom and ceremonial practices—are actively protected from deforestation, degradation, and encroachment. The project recognizes their value both to Indigenous communities and to global cultural heritage.

Additionally, capacity-building initiatives are supported to enhance Indigenous communities' skills in preserving, documenting, and transmitting their cultural heritage. This empowerment ensures their ongoing role as active guardians of their traditions, fostering intergenerational continuity and self-determined cultural vitality.

2.5.5 Statutory and Customary Property Rights (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G5.1)

The project zone is situated in a Permanent Forest Zone within the Ogooué-Ivindo Province of Gabon, covering three blocks (Mvoun, Ivindo, and Zadié departments) with a total area of 146,331 hectares. The following sections detail the tenure, use, access, and management rights related to lands, territories, and resources in this zone, based on Gabon's legal framework and contractual agreements.

Tenure Rights

Tenure rights in the project zone are clearly defined by Gabonese law and formal concessions:

- **State Ownership:** All land within the Permanent Forest Zone is owned by the Gabonese State. No private individual, enterprise, or local community holds proprietary ownership of the land itself.
- **ENB's Concession Tenure:** ENB has legally acquired the Sustainable Forest Management Concession (CFAD, Concession Forestière sous Aménagement Durable) for the project zone. This state-authorized concession constitutes ENB's formal tenure right to hold, operate, and develop the forest resources within the designated boundaries, serving as the legal foundation for its forestry activities.

- **Local Communities' Customary Tenure:** Local village communities and indigenous groups do not possess formal land ownership but hold customary tenure derived from long-standing traditional residence and resource use. This tenure is protected by Gabon's Forest Code (Law No. 016/01) and is materialized through "customary use rights".

Use Rights

Use rights are differentiated by stakeholders, with clear legal or contractual bases for each category:

- **ENB (Concession Holder):** As the CFAD holder, ENB is entitled to exploit commercial timber resources, specifically logging of authorized timber species. It also has the right to develop and operate forestry-related businesses, such as local timber processing as mandated by Gabonese regulations. Additionally, ENB may acquire economic benefits from forest resources, including revenue from processed timber sales. When the concession area is converted from forest land development to a REDD+ project, the relevant economic benefits generated shall also be obtained by ENB. These rights are supported by authorization under the CFAD, terms of the Industrial Logging License Transfer Contract, and provisions of Gabon's Forest Code.
- **Local Communities:** Local communities hold customary use rights to meet their individual and collective livelihood needs, which include multiple dimensions. In terms of timber utilization, they may use trees for construction purposes and collect dead wood and branches for firewood. For non-timber forest products (NTFPs), they are permitted to gather bark, latex, mushrooms, medicinal/edible plants, stones, rattans, and other non-timber resources. In subsistence activities, traditional hunting and fishing, subsistence agriculture, livestock grazing in savannas and forest clearings, and using branches and leaves as animal fodder are allowed. They also have the right to access and use water resources within the zone. These rights are defined by Article 252 of Gabon's Forest Code and guaranteed by Article 257 of the Forest Code, which mandates the project to reserve areas for communities to exercise these rights.

Access Rights

Access rights govern entry to the project zone and access to its resources:

- **ENB's Access:** As the CFAD holder, ENB enjoys exclusive access rights to the entire 146,331-hectare concession zone for forestry operations, including logging, construction of operational roads, and maintenance of facilities. This access is authorized by the Gabonese State and bounded by the geodetic markers and coordinate-defined boundaries specified in the CFAD and related permits.
- **Local Communities' Access:** Communities have the right to access designated reserved areas within the project zone (required by Article 257 of the Forest Code) to exercise their

customary use rights. They may also access non-reserved areas for traditional activities (e.g., hunting, NTFP collection) provided such activities do not interfere with ENB's legal logging and management operations.

Management Rights:

Management rights encompass the authority to administer, oversee, and regulate the project zone and its resources:

- **ENB:** ENB bears primary management responsibilities aligned with its CFAD obligations and REDD+ project objectives. It is required to develop and implement a REDD+ Forest Conservation and Management Plan that complies with CFAD sustainability requirements and national REDD+ standards. Additionally, ENB must establish and maintain a carbon monitoring system to track forest carbon stocks, measure emission reductions, and generate verified reports for relevant authorities. It also needs to manage community reserved areas to balance customary use with forest conservation goals, including organizing capacity-building programs for communities on sustainable resource utilization compatible with REDD+ objectives. These responsibilities stem from obligations stipulated in the CFAD, Gabon's Forest Code and national REDD+ regulations.
- **Gabonese State Authorities:** State authorities exercise regulatory and supervisory management rights. They are responsible for reviewing, approving, and supervising the implementation of ENB's forest management plan. Additionally, they oversee the designation of community reserved areas to ensure the protection of customary rights. These powers are based on Articles 252, and 257 of Gabon's Forest Code and the statutory authority of the Ministry of Forestry, Water, and Fisheries.
- **Local Communities:** Local communities participate in management through consultative and supervisory channels. They have the right to participate in consultative processes with ENB and state authorities regarding the delineation of reserved areas for customary use. They may also provide feedback on ENB's management activities that may impact their customary rights and monitor the use of reserved areas to ensure they meet community livelihood needs. Moreover, for project activities affecting their customary lands and resources, communities hold the right to grant Free, Prior, and Informed Consent (FPIC).

2.5.6 Recognition of Property Rights (VCS, 3.7, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G5.1)

The area covered by the permit is a permanent forest zone, and the ownership of the land therein belongs to the Gabonese state. ENB has obtained the Sustainable Forest Management Concession (CFAD - Concession Forestière sous Aménagement Durable) for the project area and legally holds the rights to exploit, develop, operate, and obtain related benefits in this region.

ENB fully respects and seeks to safeguard the customary use rights of local communities. In accordance with Article 257 of Gabon's The Forest Code (Law No. 016/01), this project must plan out an area of sufficient size within its scope for surrounding residents to exercise their customary use rights. According to Article 252 of The Forest Code, the exercise of customary use rights aims to meet the individual or collective needs of village communities, mainly including:

- Using trees as construction timber and using dead wood or branches as firewood;
- Collecting non-timber forest products, such as bark, latex, mushrooms, medicinal or edible plants, stones, rattans, etc.;
- Conducting traditional hunting and fishing;
- Engaging in grazing in savannas and clearings, and using branches and leaves as fodder;
- Practicing subsistence agriculture;
- Enjoying grazing rights and water use rights.

Through a series of consultations and negotiations, the project has obtained the Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) of the customary landowners. At the same time, the project supports local communities in consolidating their customary use rights by providing them with legal assistance and capacity-building. This ensures that the relevant rights and interests of indigenous peoples are fully recognized, respected, and protected throughout the implementation of the REDD+ project.

2.5.7 Free, Prior and Informed Consent (VCS, 3.18; CCB, G5.2)

Description of process for obtaining consent

ENB has conducted a Free, Prior, Informed Consent (FPIC) process under the REDD+ project adhering to the following process:

Step 1. Preparation & Stakeholder Mapping

ENB conducted a comprehensive review of national and local FPIC requirements and identified all affected Indigenous and local communities. A detailed FPIC plan was developed, outlining objectives, methods, timelines, and culturally appropriate communication strategies.

Step 2. Initial Disclosure & Inclusive Dialogue

ENB initiated open and transparent dialogues with communities to present the project's purpose, potential impacts, and benefits. Discussions were held in local languages using accessible formats to ensure full understanding and lay the groundwork for informed decision-making.

Step 3. Capacity Building & Empowerment

Training programs were delivered to communities covering topics such as REDD+, carbon rights, negotiation skills, and the FPIC process itself.

	These initiatives empowered community members to engage effectively and equitably in subsequent negotiations. Step 4. Negotiation & Agreement Formulation ENB facilitated good-faith negotiations to reach mutually acceptable agreements. The process respected traditional decision-making structures and resulted in formally documented terms covering benefits, responsibilities, and grievance mechanisms. Step 5. Consent Decision & Formalization Explicit, free, prior, and informed consent was obtained from communities. Consent was given voluntarily without coercion, based on complete understanding of the project, and formally documented in accordance with customary and legal practices. Step 6. Implementation & Ongoing Monitoring Project activities have proceeded in strict compliance with the concluded agreements. Participatory monitoring systems were established, enabling communities to jointly track implementation and ensure continued adherence to the agreed terms. Step 7. Ongoing Review & Adaptive Management The FPIC process and agreements are periodically reviewed with communities. The framework has been adapted based on feedback and lessons learned to ensure continuous improvement in transparency, accountability, and community participation.
Outcome of FPIC process	Necessary consent for the Grande Sun project's development was obtained from local communities through public consultations, which were conducted only after the project was fully disclosed and all doubts from the communities were clarified. To ensure the effectiveness of these consultations, the project adhered to established commitments, striving to make the process more participatory and open to the communities. The outcome of the FPIC process with local communities, particularly extractives, stemmed from sustained participatory engagement and negotiations. During this process, it was confirmed that the subsistence means relied on by extractives are closely linked to forest use and their in-depth understanding of the area; crucially, the project guaranteed no displacement of extractive activities, which laid the foundation for the communities to give their consent. All four core elements of FPIC were fully fulfilled with the local communities in the project area: the process was free of any coercion, intimidation, or manipulation; consent was obtained in advance; all necessary and requested information was provided to ensure the communities were fully informed; and the process was rooted in genuine consultation and active community participation. Notably, the Grande Sun project will not encroach on any private, community, or government property. It will neither displace local communities nor cause the displacement or prohibition of traditional extractives and hunting activities. Additionally, the project's FPIC process does not treat consent as a one-time event that grants a permanent social license for development. Instead, the process is designed to be

	recurring and continuous throughout the project lifecycle. As outlined in the FPIC process description, the project first sought community consent to discuss the concept of a project affecting community forests, then invited community participation in developing a detailed forest plan and will continue to engage the community in project implementation. This ongoing, participatory approach will be maintained for the duration of the project. To ensure the disclosure and transparency of the consultation process, detailed minutes were prepared, containing records of discussed matters, attendance lists, and meeting photos. These minutes were signed by community members. Furthermore, the minutes, attendance lists, and individual signatures confirming acceptance of the project will be available for review by the validation and verification body, reinforcing the transparency of the entire agreement process.
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2.5.8 Benefit Sharing Mechanisms (VCS, 3.18, 3.19;)

To ensure transparency, the project will establish clear guidelines and regular reporting procedures for the benefit-sharing mechanism. Detailed reports on fund allocation, project expenditures, and benefit distribution will be shared quarterly and annually with communities, stakeholders, and relevant authorities.

Community involvement is integral to decision-making, monitoring, and evaluation. Their feedback and suggestions will be actively solicited to strengthen accountability and transparency throughout the benefit-sharing process.

Process used to design the benefit sharing plan	The development of the benefit-sharing agreement for the Grande Sun Project involved in-depth consultations and negotiations with affected customary landowner communities. The project team began by conducting detailed mapping and documentation of customary tenure and resource-use rights within the project area, as outlined in Section 2.5.5. Building on this foundation of rights recognition, a series of participatory meetings were organized with representatives from relevant clans, tribes, and community groups. These sessions enabled community members to actively shape the decision-making process and define equitable benefit distribution mechanisms. Discussions were facilitated in local languages and incorporated traditional governance practices to ensure cultural appropriateness and meaningful inclusion throughout the process.
Summary of the benefit sharing plan	The beneficiary group will receive part of the net revenue from greenhouse gas (GHG) emission reductions after covering all project-related costs. These funds will be directed toward essential services and development programs for local communities, supporting initiatives such as community projects, infrastructure upgrades, a future generation trust, local savings and loan societies, financial literacy training, and micro- and small business development. The detailed distribution plan is pending final confirmation.
Approval and dissemination of	The benefit-sharing agreement was developed through a series of consultations and negotiations with affected stakeholder groups, culminating

benefit sharing plan

in formal endorsement and signatures by representatives of the project proponent, community, and government.

To ensure transparency and accessibility, a summary of the agreement's key terms has been published and made available in local community. The full document remains accessible to stakeholders upon request, subject to confidentiality provisions mutually agreed upon with community representatives.

The Benefit Sharing Plan (BSP) is a public document, produced in English, French, and relevant local languages upon request. Progress reports from the developer are disseminated through multiple channels beyond physical meetings.

The project will continue to convene regular meetings and workshops with participating communities to monitor the implementation of the benefit-sharing plan and adapt it as needed based on feedback and changing local priorities.

2.5.9 Property Rights Protection (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G5.3)

No displacement of individuals is anticipated as a result of the project, given its transition from logging activities to a carbon credit-based conservation model.

2.5.10 Illegal Activity Identification (VCS, 3.19; CCB, G5.4)

Within the framework of the REDD+ initiative, the project actively works to prevent and mitigate illegal activities—such as illegal logging, poaching, human trafficking, forced labor, and child labor—that could undermine its environmental and social goals. A series of targeted measures have been implemented to identify, deter, and address such practices:

A robust monitoring and reporting system are in place to detect illegal activities across the project zone. Community members are encouraged to report concerns through secure and confidential channels, enabling timely response and intervention.

Training and capacity-building programs educate local communities on sustainable resource management and the legal and social consequences of illicit activities. These efforts help cultivate a culture of compliance and environmental stewardship.

The project upholds a strict zero-tolerance policy toward human trafficking, forced labor, and child labor. This commitment is formalized in stakeholder agreements, and regular audits are conducted to ensure adherence to ethical standards. Any violations are addressed swiftly and systematically.

To reduce economic dependence on illegal practices, the project supports alternative livelihoods—including sustainable agriculture—that provide legal and sustainable income opportunities for residents.

Through these integrated actions, the project strengthens its resilience against illegal activities, protects human rights, and ensures that project benefits are derived through ethical and lawful means.

2.5.11 Ongoing Disputes (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, G5.5)

None.

2.5.12 Approvals (CCB, G5.7)

The Grande Sun project is led by ENB and covers 5 plots of land totaling 146,331 hectares across 3 provinces (Moungo, Ivindo, Zadi) in Gabon. ENB has obtained the Sustainable Managed Forest Concession (CFAD) for this area. The logging and operation rights for these 5 plots are clearly stipulated in the Provisional Agreement for Development, Exploitation and Processing (CPAET) signed between ENB and Gabon's Directorate of Water and Forests. This CPAET is a provisional legal contract entered into by the Government of Gabon (through the forest management authority) and ENB regarding the development and operation of the forest concession, granting ENB the legal right to conduct industrial forest logging activities in the region.

2.5.13 Double Counting and Participation under Other GHG Programs (VCS, 3.23; CCB G5.9)

2.5.13.1 No Double Issuance

Is the project receiving or seeking credit for reductions and removals from a project activity under another GHG program, or any other form of community, social, or biodiversity unit or credit?

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes, provide required evidence of no double issuance as outlined by the VCS Standard and the CCB Standards. Include all relevant information about the community, social, or biodiversity credit.

2.5.13.2 Registration in Other GHG Programs

Has the project registered under any other GHG programs?

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes, provide the registration number and the date of project inactivity under the other GHG program.

Is the project active under the other program?

☐ Yes ☒ No

Project proponents, or their authorized representative, must attest that the project is no longer active in the other GHG program in the Registration Representation.

2.5.13.3 Projects Rejected by Other GHG Programs

Has the project been rejected by any other GHG programs?

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes, provide the program name(s), reason(s) and date for the rejection, justification of eligibility under the VCS Program, and any other relevant information.

2.5.14 Double Claiming, Other Forms of Credit, and Scope 3 Emissions (VCS, 3.24)

2.5.14.1 No Double Claiming with Emissions Trading Programs or Binding Emission Limits

Are project reductions and removals or project activities also included in an emissions trading program or binding emission limit? See the *VCS Program Definitions* for definitions of emissions trading program and binding emission limit.

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes, provide all required evidence of no double claiming as outlined by the VCS Standard.

2.5.14.2 No Double Claiming with Other Forms of Environmental Credit

Has the project activity sought, received, or is planning to receive credit from another GHG-related environmental credit system? See the *VCS Program Definitions* for definition of GHG-related environmental credit system.

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes, provide all required evidence of no double claiming as outlined by the VCS Standard.

2.5.14.3 Supply Chain (Scope 3) Emissions

Do the project activities affect the emissions footprint of any product(s) (goods or services) that are part of a supply chain?

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes:

Is the project proponent(s) or authorized representative a buyer or seller of the product(s) (goods or services) that are part of a supply chain?

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes:

Has the project proponent(s) or authorized representative posted a public statement on their website saying, "Carbon credits may be issued through Verified Carbon Standard project [project ID] for the greenhouse gas emission reductions or removals associated with [project

proponent or authorized representative organization name(s)] [name of product(s) whose emissions footprint is changed by the project activities].”?

☐ Yes

☒ No

If yes to all:

Provide evidence of the public statement. Evidence must be provided in this section or in an appendix.

2.6 Additional Information Relevant to the Project

2.6.1 Leakage Management (VCS, 3.11, 3.15)

Negative leakage poses a significant risk to regional forest conservation by redirecting pressures on ecosystems from one area to another. This occurs when activity shifting—such as the displacement of people, technology, or capital from a newly protected or REDD+-covered zone to an unprotected region—triggers deforestation elsewhere. Additionally, market leakage can result when reduced timber or agricultural output within the project area leads to increased extraction or land conversion in other locations, further undermining conservation outcomes. To mitigate leakage, following actions are planned to address the leakage issues:

To mitigate potential leakage, a community-use buffer zone has been designated. It accounts for 15% of the project area (equivalent to 21,950 hectares). This area allows local communities to continue their daily livelihood activities while reducing pressure on surrounding forests. The buffer zone supports environmental stewardship at the landscape level and helps prevent conflicts by accommodating traditional community uses. Conservation interventions are integrated with livelihood improvements, including co-management of protected areas by communities and conservation agencies to enhance ecological outcomes.

The selection of the buffer zone followed specific, multi-dimensional criteria to maximize its effectiveness, with each criterion reflecting meticulous consideration of both community needs and conservation goals. To minimize the need for communities to travel long distances—and thus discourage potential forest encroachment in other areas—priority was first given to areas near existing villages and community facilities. Meanwhile, to respect local traditions and ensure the buffer zone aligns with daily livelihood practices, zones with historical and customary uses (such as gardening, hunting, and wild resource gathering) were carefully identified through participatory land-use planning, ensuring the buffer zone integrates naturally with community life. In terms of conservation impact, areas with lower carbon stocks—including secondary forests and degraded forests—were preferred, as this choice significantly reduces the risk of "leakage" (the displacement of deforestation pressures to non-project areas). To safeguard ecological integrity, ecologically sensitive regions and critical habitats for endangered species were explicitly excluded from buffer zone eligibility, preventing any compromise to high-priority conservation targets. Finally, to ensure the entire selection process is inclusive and legitimate, the final delineation of the buffer zone was fully endorsed by local communities and

clans through the Free, Prior, and Informed Consent (FPIC) procedures, ensuring their voices and interests are central to the decision-making.

2.6.2 Further Information

None.

3 CLIMATE

3.1 Application of Methodology

3.1.1 Title and Reference of Methodology (VCS, 3.1)

The Grande Sun Project is designed for validation pursuant to the Verified Carbon Standard Version 4.7 and the AFOLU Requirements Version 3.6. The project utilizes VM0048 Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation Version 1.0 (VM0048, Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Degradation, v1.0 (verra.org)) in instances where it is materially applicable and employs VM0007 REDD+ Methodology Framework (REDD-MF) where VM0048 is not materially applicable. Modules to establish analogous requirements for forest degradation and planned deforestation are currently under development. The module for Avoiding Planned Deforestation is anticipated to be released in 2024. Pursuant to this REDD Methodology Framework, the following modules and tools are utilized by the project:

Type (methodology, tool, module)	Reference ID (if applicable)	Title	Version
Methodology	VM0048	VM0048 Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Deforestation	1.0
Methodology	VM0007	VM0007 REDD+ Methodology Framework (REDD-MF)	1.8
Additionality	VT0001	VT0001 Tool for the demonstration and assessment of additionality in VCS Agriculture, Forestry and Other Land Use (AFOLU) Project activities,	3.0
Permanence	T-BAR	VCS AFOLU Non-Permanence Risk Tool,	4.2

Baseline	VMD0006	VMD0006 Estimation of baseline carbon stock changes and greenhouse gas emissions from planned deforestation/forest degradation and planned wetland degradation (BL-PL),	1.4
Carbon pool above- and belowground biomass	VMD0001	VMD0001 Estimation of carbon stocks in the above- and belowground biomass in live tree and non-tree pools (CP-AB),	1.2
Carbon pool wood products	VMD0005	VMD0005 Estimation of carbon stocks in the long-term wood products pool (CP-W),	1.2
Monitoring	VMD0015	VMD0015 Methods for monitoring of GHG emissions and removals in REDD and CIW projects (M-REDD),	2.3
Stratification	VMD0016	VMD0016 Methods for stratification of the project area (X-STR),	1.3
Uncertainty	VMD0017	VMD0017 Estimation of uncertainty for REDD project activities (X-UNC),	2.2
Significance	VM0048 APPENDIX 1	APPENDIX 1: TESTING SIGNIFICANCE OF GHG EMISSIONS	1.0

3.1.2 Applicability of Methodology (VCS, 3.1)

As described below, the project activities for the **Grande Sun Project Area** satisfy each of the applicability conditions for VM0048 Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation, for VM0048 wherever it is materially applicable, and for VM0007 REDD+ Methodology Framework wherever VM0048 is not materially applicable, as well as for the various tools and modules applied by the project. The project qualifies as a REDD project under VM0048 and VM0007 REDD-MF for the following reasons:

Reference ID/Title	Applicability condition	Justification of conformance
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VM0048 wherever it has material and VM0007 wherever VM0048 has no material	Land in the project area has qualified as forest (following the definition used by the VCS; in addition, see Section 5.1.2) for at least the 10 years prior to the project start date. Mangrove forests are excluded from any tree height requirement in a forest definition, as they consist of 95 percent mangrove species, which often do not reach the same height as other tree species. Mangroves occupy contiguous areas and their functioning as a forest is independent of tree height.	Land in the Grande Sun Project Area has qualified as forest (following the definition used by VCS) at least 10 years before the project start date ;
VM0048 wherever it has material and VM0007 wherever VM0048 has no material	Where land within the project area is peatland or tidal wetlands and emissions from the SOC pool are deemed significant, the relevant WRC modules (see Table 3) are applied alongside other relevant modules.	There are no peat soils and tidal wetlands present in the Grande Sun Project Area;
VM0048 wherever it has material and VM0007 wherever VM0048 has no material	Baseline deforestation in the project area falls within either of the following categories: a) Unplanned deforestation (VCS category AUDef) Planned deforestation (VCS category APDef)	Baseline deforestation and forest degradation in the project area falls within the category of Planned deforestation/degradation (VCS category APD);
VM0048 wherever it has material and VM0007 wherever VM0048 has no material	REDD activity types are not applicable under the following conditions: Leakage prevention activities include: a) Flooding agricultural lands to increase	Leakage mitigation activities under the project do not encompass agricultural lands that are flooded to increase production (e.g., rice paddies), nor do they include the intensification of livestock production through the use of feedlots and/or manure lagoons.

	production (e.g., rice paddies); and/or b) Intensifying livestock production through use of feed-lots and/or manure lagoons.	
VM0048 wherever it has material and VM0007 wherever VM0048 has no material	Avoiding planned deforestation activities are applicable under the following condition: Where conversion of forest lands to a deforested condition is legally permitted	The project qualifies as an Avoided Planned Deforestation/Degradation project (VCS category APD) because: Project documentation clearly demonstrates that, absent the REDD intervention, the land within the project area would have been converted to non-forest uses. The project proponents can show ownership of the project site and ownership of the carbon rights for the project area; The proposed activities within the project area do not contravene any applicable laws, irrespective of the level of enforcement.
VM0048	This methodology may only be used for eligible REDD projects and activities described in the VCS Methodology Requirements. The applicability conditions for each activity type are listed in AUDef and will be listed in APDef and AUDeg.	Based on all of the above information, it is clear that this project is an Avoided Planned Deforestation project (APDef). Applicability condition is met.
VT0001	The tool is applicable under the following conditions: a) AFOLU activities the same or similar to the proposed project activity on the land within the proposed project boundary performed with or without being registered as the VCS AFOLU project shall not lead to violation of any	The planned project activities within the forest area consist of avoiding deforestation and conserving forest resources, and are fully compliant with all applicable laws and regulations in Gabon. This includes, inter alia, environmental protection legislation, land-use regulations, and policies governing carbon credit projects. While enforcement practices may vary in practice, the project proponents have

	applicable law even if the law is not enforced; b) The use of this tool to determine additionality requires the baseline methodology to provide for a stepwise approach justifying the determination of the most plausible baseline scenario. Project proponent(s) proposing new baseline methodologies shall ensure consistency between the determination of a baseline scenario and the determination of additionality of a project activity.	confirmed that the proposed activities contravene no legal provisions. By foregoing deforestation and promoting conservation, E.N.B. ensures alignment with national and international legal frameworks, thereby satisfying this requirement.
T-BAR	/	This document sets out the procedures for completing a non-permanence risk analysis to determine the non-permanence risk rating ("risk rating"), which shall be used to determine the number of buffer credits that an AFOLU project shall deposit into the AFOLU pooled buffer account (the procedure for depositing buffer credits is set out in the Registration and Issuance Process).
VMD0006	The module is applicable for estimating the baseline emissions on forest² lands (usually privately or government owned) that are legally authorized and documented to be converted to non-forest land. Where, pre-project, unsustainable fuelwood collection is occurring within the project boundaries Modules BL-DFW and LK-DFW must be used to determine potential leakage.	The forest in Gabon is legally owned by E.N.B., which possesses documented and uncontested rights to convert the forest to non-forest uses, including agricultural development. These rights are recognized under applicable land-use laws and regulations in Gabon. The baseline scenario therefore assumes large-scale deforestation for commercial crop production, consistent with the legal authorization to convert the land. As the project entails the avoidance of planned deforestation, this requirement is fully met, and the baseline emissions are estimated on the basis of legally

		permissible activities that are averted by the project intervention.
VMD0001	This module is applicable to all forest types and age classes.	This module is applicable to all forest types and age classes.
VMD0005	This module is applicable to all cases where wood is harvested for conversion to wood products for commercial markets, for all forest types and age classes.	This module is applicable to all cases where wood is harvested for conversion to wood products for commercial markets, for all forest types and age classes.
VMD0015	Strata as defined in the relevant baseline modules are fixed and may not be changed without baseline revision. The module is mandatory for REDD, CIW-REDD, RWE-REDD and stand-alone CIW project activities.	The module is mandatory for REDD, CIW-REDD, RWE-REDD and stand-alone CIW project activities.
VMD0017	This module is mandatory when using methodology REDD+ MF.	This module is mandatory when using methodology REDD+ MF.
VM0048 APPENDIX 1	Appendix 1 of VM 0048 methodology must be used to determine significance.	Appendix 1 of VM 0048 methodology must be used to determine significance.

Justification for Exclusion of Modules BL-DFW and LK-DFW

While satellite imagery indicates that scattered dwellings exist within the project area around Ovan, Makokou, and Mékambo in northeastern Gabon, the decision not to apply BL-DFW (Baseline Module for Degradation from Fuelwood Collection) and LK-DFW (Leakage Module for Fuelwood Collection) is based on the following considerations:

- i) **Low Fuelwood Pressure Baseline:** Field consultations in villages along the Mvoundou and Ivindo rivers and pre-project household surveys indicate that resident communities primarily rely on deadwood and fallen branches collected within short walking distances from settlements for subsistence energy use. No evidence of commercial-scale or systematic extraction of live biomass was observed in the Ogooué-Ivindo interior, and local forestry posts report no organized fuelwood market serving these towns.

- ii) Cultural and Energy Practices: Population density in Ovan, Makokou, and Mékambo is low, and traditional cooking practices involve low-intensity biomass use adapted to humid rainforest conditions. Households commonly supplement with alternative materials such as palm fronds, nut husks (e.g., *Raphia* residues), and crop residues from cassava and plantain plots; occasional use of kerosene or small LPG canisters in market centers like Makokou further reduces pressure on live woody biomass.
- iii) Spatial Limitation of Access: Despite some dwellings being within the project boundary, settlements are highly clustered along roads and riverbanks and are surrounded by dense terra firme forest, swamp forests, and dissected terrain. Seasonal flooding and waterlogged soils, particularly near Mékambo and along the Ivindo, limit access beyond localized collection zones near paths and old fields.
- iv) Buffer Zone Design: The project has designated 15% of the area as a community use buffer zone adjacent to settlements and agroforestry mosaics, within which fuelwood needs are to be sustainably met through the collection of deadwood and monitoring of use. This internal allocation reduces the pressure to extract fuelwood beyond the designated zones and minimizes the risk of activity-shifting leakage.
- v) No Significant Change in Demand Expected: There are no foreseeable drivers of increased fuelwood demand (e.g., population growth, migration, or commercial harvesting). Therefore, leakage from future expansion is considered immaterial.

3.1.3 Project Boundary (VCS, 3.12)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

3.1.4 Baseline Scenario (VCS, 3.13)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

3.1.5 Additionality (VCS, 3.14)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

3.1.5.1 Regulatory Surplus (VCS, 3.14)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

3.1.5.2 Additionality Methods (VCS, 3.14)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

3.1.6 Methodology Deviations (VCS, 3.20)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

3.2 Quantification of Estimated GHG Emission Reductions and Removals

3.2.1 Baseline Emissions (VCS, 3.15)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

3.2.2 Project Emissions (VCS, 3.15)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

3.2.3 Leakage Emissions (VCS 2.5, 3.2, 3.6, 3.15, 4.3)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

3.2.4 Estimated GHG Emission Reductions and Carbon Dioxide Removals (VCS, 3.15, 4.1)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

3.3 Monitoring

3.3.1 Data and Parameters Available at Validation (VCS, 3.16)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

3.3.2 Data and Parameters Monitored (VCS, 3.16)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

3.3.3 Monitoring Plan (VCS, 3.16, 3.20)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

3.3.4 Dissemination of Monitoring Plan and Results (VCS, 3.18; CCB, CL4.2)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

3.4 Optional Criterion: Climate Change Adaptation Benefits

3.4.1 Regional Climate Change Scenarios (CCB, GL1.1)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

3.4.2 Climate Change Impacts (CCB, GL1.2)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

3.4.3 Measures Needed and Designed for Adaptation (CCB, GL1.3)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4 COMMUNITY

4.1 Without-Project Community Scenario

4.1.1 Descriptions of Communities at Project Start (CCB, CM1.1)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.1.2 Interactions between Communities and Community Groups (VCS, 3.19; CCB, CM1.1)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.1.3 High Conservation Values (CCB, CM1.2)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.1.4 Without-Project Scenario: Community (CCB, CM1.3)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.2 Net Positive Community Impacts

4.2.1 Expected Community Impacts (CCB, CM2.1)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.2.2 Negative Community Impact Mitigation (VCS, 3.19; CCB, CM2.2)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.2.3 Net Positive Community Well-Being (VCS, 3.19; CCB, CM2.3, GL1.4)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.2.4 High Conservation Values Protected (CCB, CM2.4)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.3 Other Stakeholder Impacts

4.3.1 Impacts on Other Stakeholders (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, CM3.1)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.3.2 Mitigation of Negative Impacts on Other Stakeholders (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, CM3.2)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.3.3 Net Impacts on Other Stakeholders (VCS, 3.18, 3.19; CCB, CM3.3)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.4 Community Impact Monitoring

4.4.1 Community Monitoring Plan (CCB, CM4.1, CM4.2, GL1.4, GL2.2, GL2.3, GL2.5)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.4.2 Monitoring Plan Dissemination (CCB, CM4.3)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.5 Optional Criterion: Exceptional Community Benefits

4.5.1 Exceptional Community Criteria (CCB, GL2.1)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7..

4.5.2 Short-term and Long-term Community Benefits (CCB, GL2.2)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.5.3 Community Participation Risks (CCB, GL2.3)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.5.4 Marginalized and/or Vulnerable Community Groups (CCB, GL2.4)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.5.5 Net Impacts on Women (CCB, GL2.5)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.5.6 Benefit Sharing Mechanisms (CCB, GL2.6)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.5.7 Benefits, Costs, and Risks Communication (VCS, 3.18; CCB, GL2.7)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.5.8 Governance and Implementation Structures (CCB, GL2.8)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

4.5.9 Smallholders/Community Members Capacity Development (CCB, GL2.9)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5 BIODIVERSITY

5.1 Without-Project Biodiversity Scenario

5.1.1 Existing Conditions (VCS, 3.19; CCB, B1.1)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.1.2 High Conservation Values (CCB, B1.2)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.1.3 Without-project Scenario: Biodiversity (CCB, B1.3)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.2 Net Positive Biodiversity Impacts

5.2.1 Expected Biodiversity Changes (VCS, 3.19; CCB, B2.1)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.2.2 Mitigation Measures (VCS, 3.19; CCB, B2.3)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.2.3 Net Positive Biodiversity Impacts (CCB, B2.2, GL1.4)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.2.4 High Conservation Values Protected (CCB, B2.4)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.2.5 Species Used (VCS, 3.19; CCB, B2.5, B2.6)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.2.6 Invasive Species (VCS, 3.19; CCB, B2.5)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.2.7 GMO Exclusion (CCB, B2.7)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.2.8 Inputs Justification (VCS, 3.19; CCB, B2.8)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.2.9 Waste Products (VCS, 3.19; CCB, B2.9)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.3 Offsite Biodiversity Impacts

5.3.1 Negative Offsite Biodiversity Impacts (CCB, B3.1) and Mitigation Measures (CCB, B3.2)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.3.2 Net Offsite Biodiversity Benefits (VCS, 3.19; CCB, B3.3)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.4 Biodiversity Impact Monitoring

5.4.1 Biodiversity Monitoring Plan (CCB, B4.1, B4.2, GL1.4, GL3.4)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.4.2 Biodiversity Monitoring Plan Dissemination (CCB, B4.3)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.5 Optional Criterion: Exceptional Biodiversity Benefits

5.5.1 High Biodiversity Conservation Priority Status (CCB, GL3.1)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

5.5.2 Trigger Species Population Trends (CCB, GL3.2, GL3.3)

Section not required for the Under Development stage in accordance to Verra's Registration and Issuance Process v4.7.

APPENDIX 1: PROJECT RISKS TABLE

	Identified risk(s)	Potential impact of risk on stakeholders, ecosystem health, and biodiversity	Mitigation or preventative measure(s) taken
Natural and human induced risks to stakeholders' wellbeing	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project encompasses thorough monitoring and evaluation processes designed to alleviate any threats to stakeholder well-being, whether they arise from natural causes or human activities.
Risks to stakeholder participation	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project incorporates extensive monitoring and evaluation measures intended to address and minimize any risks to the welfare of stakeholders, irrespective of whether these dangers stem from natural events or human interventions.
Working conditions	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project complies with rigorous labor standards and regulations, thereby guaranteeing safe and equitable working environments for all individuals involved.
Safety of women and girls	No risk identified	No risk identified	Irreversible damage or danger to the safety of women and girls will not occur.
Safety of minority and marginalized groups, including children	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project ensures that there will be no overall adverse impact on the safety of minority and marginalized communities, encompassing children.

Pollutants (air, noise, discharges to water, generation of waste, and release of hazardous materials and chemical pesticides and fertilizers)	No risk identified	No risk identified	Being a REDD project, it does not produce any pollutants as a result of its activities.
Discrimination	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project advocates for and implements policies against discrimination, thereby guaranteeing fair treatment to be extended to every stakeholder involved.
Sexual harassment	No risk identified	No risk identified	Training programs are in place to proactively prevent and effectively respond to any occurrences of sexual harassment within the scope of the project.
Equal pay for equal work	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project is dedicated to upholding equitable wage policies, guaranteeing that all employees receive equal compensation for comparable work.
Gender equity in labor and work	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project aimed at achieving gender equality are incorporated into both the planning and implementation stages of the project, with the goal of fostering equal opportunities across all genders.
Forced labor ²⁰	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project categorically forbids the use of forced labor and incorporates strategies to

²⁰ The identified risks and commensurate mitigation or preventative measure(s) for forced labor, child labor, and human trafficking, must be inclusive of staff and contracted workers employed by third parties.

			guarantee adherence to human rights and labor legislation.
Child labor	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project strictly prohibits child labor and includes measures to ensure compliance with human rights and labor laws.
Human trafficking	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project firmly prohibits the employment of child labor and has implemented measures to safeguard adherence to human rights and labor legislation.
Recognition of, respect of, and promotion of the rights to IPs, LCs and customary rights holders	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project proactively collaborates with Indigenous Peoples and Local Communities, acknowledging and supporting their rights and welfare.
Preserving and protecting cultural heritage	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project is dedicated to the active conservation and safeguarding of cultural heritage. This is achieved through discussions held during community meetings and stakeholder consultations.
Protecting and preserving property rights, customary rights, or protecting legal or customary tenure/access rights to territories, property, and resources, including collective and/or conflicting rights	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project upholds and safeguards the property and traditional rights of all parties involved.

Impacts on biodiversity and ecosystems	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project is designed to cause no adverse effects on biodiversity, as it focuses on the conservation of forests and the prevention of deforestation.
Soil degradation and soil erosion	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project is detrimental to neither the soil nor the environment, as it prioritizes the preservation of forests and the avoidance of deforestation.
Water consumption and stress	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project does not impact water usage or exert stress on water resources, and it is also aimed at supplying the community with clean drinking water.
Habitats (and areas needed for habitat connectivity) for rare, threatened, and endangered species	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project causes no damage to habitats and actively works to protect the living environments of endangered species.
Areas needed for habitat connectivity	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project guarantees the preservation of habitat connectivity.
Invasive species	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project will not introduce any non-native or invasive species.
Ecosystem conversion	No risk identified	No risk identified	The project concentrates on the preservation of natural ecological systems.

APPENDIX 2: COMMERCIALY SENSITIVE INFORMATION

Section	Information	Justification
Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable

